THE IRISH OF ERRIS, CO. MAYO

A Phonemic Study

by

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PREFACE

THE barony of Erris occupies the north-west corner of the Co. Mayo. Broadhaven from the north and Blacksod Bay from the south penetrate to meet at the isthmus of Belmullet and cut off from the rest the Mullet peninsula[1] to the west. On the east Erris adjoins the barony of Tirawly. The term Erris, in the language of the older inhabitants of Dû[2] Chaocháin, is of restricted meaning and applied to the Mullet peninsula only. P. Knight, at p. 4 of his book,[3] writes : ' Erris means western peninsula and strictly speaking should be confined to the portion within the isthmus of the Mullet, . . . the natives call all beyond that " the mountains ".'

At two points in the barony I found Irish in full vigour as the vernacular : (1) Faulmore and adjacent townlands to the west ; (2) Dû Chaocháin, comprising Kilgalligan, Carrateigue, Stonefield, and Cornboy, in the north of the barony beside Beinn Bhuí Head. At these two places Irish was in 1936 the everyday speech of old and young, and the majority of the children acquired their first knowledge of English on attending school. Many of the older people knew Irish only.

The entire population of the two islands of Inishkea had been accommodated in new holdings by the Irish Land Commission at Glosh and Nakil[4] on the opposite mainland soon after 1930. In their new homes on the mainland these migrants from Inishkea formed a compact community whose main pursuit continued to be fishing. They have always been entirely Irish speaking.

Faulmore was, before the Land Commission's scheme of consolidation there was completed in 1936–37, an old-world rural village or ' baile ', made up of a score or more of thatched houses built close to one another. The main harvest of the community was from the sea. With the coming of consolidation each household acquired additional land and a new dwelling on its own

[1] Irish Geography, the Bulletin of the Geographical Society of Ireland, Vol. IV, no. 1 (1959), contains, with maps, two instructive articles on the Mullet.

[2] û = *ú* nasalized.

[3] Erris in the Irish Highlands, Dublin, 1836.

[4] In Irish now *Tóin na hOltaí*.

holding. The old village was demolished. In the past Faulmore had considerable contact with the Inishkea islands, and intermarriage between members of the two communities was not uncommon.

Doohoma is on the southern coast of the small peninsula or headland south-west of Geesala village, and has its extension in Ceann Reamhar Head pointing in the direction of Achill. In Doohoma in 1935 those of the older generation were fluent Irish speakers, but English was fast replacing Irish as the everyday speech of the younger generation and those of school-going age. There has been heavy emigration to Scotland and England for many years from Doohoma district.

Minor differences of speech are noticeable as one travels from one point to another of the places I have mentioned. These are not very marked, however, and are differences rather of vocabulary than of sounds or accidence. In Dû Chaocháin in the north, for instance, they seem to use more typically Donegal[1] words than in Faulmore.

As between Faulmore and Inishkea speech there was a very marked difference in intonation. Characteristic of Inishkea was a striking monotone which I did not observe elsewhere in Erris. The final syllable of an utterance was unduly drawn out or lengthened. Inishkea migrants now after thirty years' residence on the mainland have—most of them—lost much of this peculiar intonation.

Phonetically and in its accidence Erris Irish is in marked contrast with the Irish of Ballycroy and Achill, where Donegal influence is much in evidence.[2] Doohoma folk used to quote the Ballycroy version of the proverb ' cat after kind ', viz. *siúl a' chuit ag a' phisín*, for which Doohoma people said *siúl a' chait ag a' bpisín*. They contrasted, too, *ar a' phortach, insa bhád, ar a' bhethíoch*, of Ballycroy, with their own *ar a' bportach, insa mbád, ar a' mbethíoch*. They also adverted to the Achill and Ballycroy pronunciation of *déanamh* as *deánú*, for which they in Doohoma would say *díonú*.

[1] One example is *murlus* ' a mackerel ', for which Faulmore has *ronnach*, the usual word in West Connacht generally.

[2] For an account of the settling of a Donegal colony in Ballycroy see O'Rahilly, Irish Dialects, p. 189.

The Irish of Erris seems to be typical of Mayo Irish in general ; it is conservative in its sounds, as also in its declensional patterns, and has not gravely digressed from Classical Irish, though there are some features in which it shows a striking departure from classical forms. Two scholars in the past have had observations to make which are apposite here and may be quoted. John Mac Neill in *Clare Island Survey*, Section 1, part 3, p. 7, says of the local dialect of Clare Island : ' Its phonetic system is the best preserved of all the extant Irish dialects known to me, that is to say, is the most fully in conformity with the orthography of Early Modern Irish.' T. F. O'Rahilly in his *Irish Dialects*, p. 246, remarks : ' On the whole it would seem that the Irish of N. Connacht has the fewest deviations from the older pronunciation.' Their remarks would appear to be equally applicable to the Irish of Erris today.

Erris has had its poet in Riocard Bairéad, familiarly known in the district as Dick Buiréad, who lived in the latter half of the 18th and early part of the 19th century. The year of his death very probably was 1819. He composed many ballads, topical, bright, and light of touch, and his ironic satire is still savoured by Errismen. Knight[1] in 1836 wrote of him : ' One man of real genius died about sixteen or eighteen years ago.' He goes on to describe him as ' sweet, correct, mellifluous in his language and verse . . . ; his songs were sung and listened to.' He ' seemed to follow the style of Swift, . . . was an enthusiastic admirer of his.'

The bulk of the material for this work was collected as long ago as 1935 and 1936. In both these years I spent the Easter and longer summer vacation periods in Erris, staying longer at Faulmore than at anywhere else there. In Faulmore my principal informant, on whose speech this work is based, was Stiofán Beag Ó Maolfhábhaill, a monoglot speaker of Irish, then in his sixties. He was steeped in the traditions of the district, and had lived all his life in his native Faulmore except for a short period when as a child of two he was taken to America, of which he had scarcely any recollection at all. His home was the ' visiting ' house where the local young men gathered in the evenings *ag cuartaigheacht*, and there among them I was always Stiofán's

[1] Op. cit., p. 120 sq.

cordially welcome guest. With him by day on his little plot of land or by the seashore, and at his home in the evenings, I was able to collect those words, phrases, and pieces of local lore on which I mainly relied as material for my study. Stiofán was ever patient with my enquiries and proud to be able to help me. I should like to place on record here, so many years afterwards, how grateful I have felt to him and the many others who gladly recited for me their songs, stories, and traditions.

As for Erris itself, I cannot do better than repeat what Knight wrote[1] about it a century and a quarter ago: 'Early associations and recollections of friends, as well as of scenery never to be forgotten, make it dear to him.'

In its main sections this work resembles the earlier monographs of the series published by the Dublin Institute for Advanced Studies. It consists of two parts. In the first are set down the sounds of the living speech of today, just as if one were recording an unwritten language. Classical historical spelling—when it is available—is added for the purpose of identification of words. In the case of words which are not found in Early Modern Irish, the more recent dictionary spellings, if they exist, are adopted. In Part II the spelling of E. Mod. Ir. is taken as the starting point, as indicating E. Mod. Ir. pronunciation, and the subsequent development of the sounds in the dialect is shown. Additional in this work is the grammatical supplement in which an outline of the main features of the accidence and morphology of the dialect is given.

The phonetic system employed is that of Professor Daniel Jones, and is based on the phoneme theory. Two of his works *An Outline of English Phonetics*, and *The Phoneme* have given guidance throughout.

In the summer of 1941 it was my good fortune to be able to attend the course at the Dublin Institute for Advanced Studies given by Miss E. Evans (now Mrs. Whitley). My training in phonetics I owe to her, and I still have pleasant memories of her lectures.

That this work appears in print today is due to Professor Myles Dillon, present Director of the School of Celtic Studies. From

[1] Op. cit., p. vii.

Professor Dillon I have received every encouragement and facility, for which I feel deeply grateful.

Professor Ó Cuív read a draft of the work in manuscript. I am indebted to him for pointing out to me a number of inconsistencies, errors, and faults of principle, and for making some very helpful suggestions as to how improvements might be made.

I have to thank Professor Delargy, editor of *Béaloideas*, for permission to reprint here parts of the story *Mártan an Bhradáin Ghil*, which has been already published in full (without phonetic text) in Iml. IX—Uimh. 1, pp. 106–113, of that journal; and Professor Ó Cuív, present editor of *Éigse*, for permitting me to reprint the song *Tomás Ó Fionáidh*, which appeared in *Éigse* II, pp. 33 sq.

I revisited Faulmore in the summer of 1961 and spent the greater part of a month there. None of my informants of 1935–36, it was sad to find, was still living. I paid two visits there again in the summer of 1962. Of my Dû Chaocháin informants of 1935–36 POC is still alive.

Abbreviated References employed in Texts and elsewhere:

Names of, and notes on, my principal Informants of 1935–36:

In Faulmore

Sb — Stiofán Beag Ó Maolfhábhaill (Stephen Lavelle). He was then in his sixties. His speech forms the basis of this work. † March 1947.

EOM — Éamonn Ó Maolfhábhaill (Edward Lavelle). He was in his eighties, had lived his whole life in Faulmore, and was a particularly clear monoglot Irish speaker. † 18 March 1943.

Lb — Liam Beag Ó Catháin (William Keane). Liam was another monoglot speaker, then about seventy; he never lived away from Faulmore. He had some of the shorter type of traditional stories.

In Glosh

CM — Ceití Monaghan. Ceití was Mrs. Geraghty, but was familiarly known by her maiden name. She was then over seventy. A brilliant conversationist in English or Irish, she knew a number of Irish prayers in verse. She was born and reared at Leam some few miles to the north of Glosh. In her youth she had been to America for a short stay. See *Éigse* II, pp. 32, 39 sq.

In Doivleán (an Chlochair)

POR — Páraic Ó Raghailligh (Patrick Reilly). He was aged about seventy. He gave me some tales and songs.

In Morahan (near Baurhave)

PB — Peadar Bairéad (Peter Barrett). Peadar had a good fund of Irish songs, and was a fine speaker of Irish, though English was his more usual language. He seemed to be then over seventy.

In Doohoma

AOS — Aodh Ó Sgannail (Hugh Scanlon). He seemed to be then about sixty. He kept a shop at Cnoc na Mónadh, Doohoma. Earlier he had spent some years in America, but even there, it seems, he never lost his regard for the language of his youth. He knew many Irish songs. † 17 May 1947.

In Dû Chaocháin

SOG — Seán Ó Gionnáin[1] (John Gannon). John was born at Cornboy, but was then living at Kilgalligan, a short distance away. He was aged eighty-six, and had lived all his life in Dû Chaocháin. He spoke only Irish.

[1] More correctly Mhag Fhionnáin.

From him I took down a number of traditional tales and songs.

PAG — Páraic Mhag Oireachtaigh (Patrick Geraghty). He lived at Stonefield (Ceathramha na gCloch). He was a keen fisherman ; and appeared to be between fifty and sixty. He gave me a number of Irish songs.

POC — Páraic Ó Cuideagáin[1] (Patrick Deane). He lived at Carrateigue, and seemed then in his forties. From him I wrote down some Irish songs.

My informants at Faulmore in 1961–62 were the following :

Wm — Liam Ó hEimhrín (William Hefferon) of Cartrongilbert. William was a man of education, with a keen interest in local history. † 17 Nov. 1962.

SBh — Seán Bhilín Ó Maolfhábhaill (John Lavelle) ; in his seventies.

MMt — Mícheál Mhac a' tSaoir (Michael Mac Intyre) ; about seventy.

MCd — Mícheál Ó Corradhuibh (Michael Corduff) ; somewhat over seventy.

[1] For this surname see Éigse VI, p. 114, ftn. 1.

PART I

PHONETIC ANALYSIS AND TEXTS

CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTORY

THE ORGANS OF SPEECH

1. The organs of speech are the lips, teeth, teeth-ridge, hard palate, soft palate (or velum), uvula, tongue, and vocal chords. The tongue for phonetic purposes is divided into three parts: the blade (including the tip), which lies opposite the teeth-ridge; the front, lying opposite the hard palate; and the back, opposite the soft palate.

2. The vocal chords are membranes stretched across the larynx. The space between the vocal chords is the glottis. Sounds accompanied by vibration of the vocal chords are termed voiced, while sounds uttered with open glottis, that is to say when the vocal chords are apart and without vibration, are said to be unvoiced or voiceless.

3. The soft palate, like the tongue, lips, and vocal chords, is a movable organ of speech. When it is raised to touch the back wall of the throat, the air passes outwards through the mouth. Sounds uttered with the soft palate so raised are termed oral or buccal. The soft palate may be lowered, leaving the passage to the nose open, so that some or all of the air escapes through the nose, thus producing nasal sounds.

CLASSIFICATION OF VOWELS

4. Vowels are classified according to the position of the tongue and the state of the lips. The mouth is a resonance chamber, the shape of which is modified by the tongue's position. The tongue may occupy a relatively high or low position in the mouth,

thus determining a vowel's quality. When the front of the tongue is the part raised highest the vowel then formed is said to be a front vowel. When it is the back of the tongue that is raised, the vowel is termed a back vowel. With raising of the central part of the tongue central vowels are formed. According to the degree of height of tongue-raising vowels are classified as close or open vowels. With the highest degree of tongue-raising close vowels are produced ; with the lowest degree of raising open vowels are formed. At one third of the distance from close to open is the half-close position. The half-open line lies at two thirds the distance from close to open position. In simpler words, close vowels are formed with high tongue position and open vowels with low tongue position ; the intermediate positions give half-close and half-open vowels.

Cardinal Vowels

5. For purposes of comparison a scale of standard Cardinal Vowels was devised by Prof. Daniel Jones. These vowels have known acoustic quality. Their tongue and lip positions are fixed. They serve as standard vowels with which all other vowel sounds can be compared. But before they can be of use for purposes of comparison, they must be learned thoroughly from a teacher who can accurately reproduce them, or failing this from the gramophone record. Prof. Jones has recorded the Primary Cardinal Vowels, and has also made a recording of the Secondary Cardinal Vowels. Both these records are issued by the Linguaphone Institute, with the numbers ENG 254–55 and 252–3. In this book, however, we are concerned with the Primary Cardinal Vowels only.

6. Cardinal Vowel No. 1 (**i**) is formed by raising the front of the tongue as high and as forward as possible without moving into the friction area. It is produced with spread lips.

7. Cardinal Vowel No. 5 (**ɑ**) is formed with the back of the tongue as low and as far retracted as possible without causing friction. The lips during its formation are neutrally open.

8. Cardinal Vowel No. 8 (**u**) is formed with the back of the tongue raised as high and as far back as possible without causing friction.

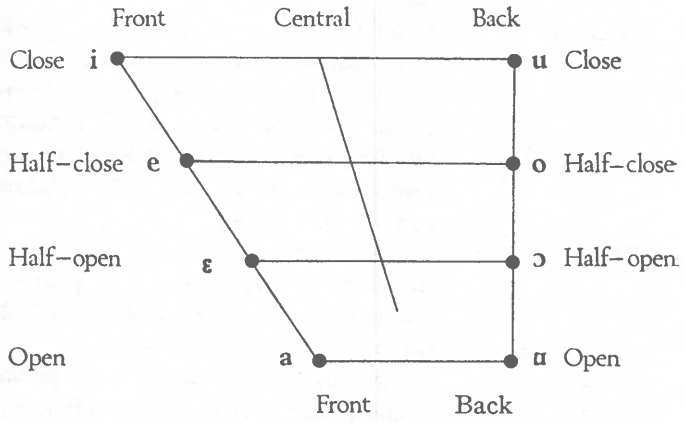
9. Cardinal Vowel No. 4 (**a**) is formed when the front of the tongue is in the lowest and most forward position.

10. These four vowel positions give the four corners, as it were, of the Cardinal Vowel Figure. Cardinal Vowels No. 2 (**e**) and No. 3 (**ɛ**) occupy at equal intervals the tongue positions between Nos. 1 and 4. Thus a sequence of acoustically equidistant front vowels is formed, viz. **i e ɛ a.** In passing from Cardinal **i** to **e** and **ɛ** and **a** the lips are gradually becoming less spread and are tending to open.

11. Similarly between Cardinal Vowels No. 5 (**ɑ**) and No. 8 (**u**) the half-open and half-close positions are occupied respectively by Cardinal Vowels No. 6 (**ɔ**) and No. 7 (**o**). Thus Cardinal Vowels **ɑ ɔ o u** likewise constitute a sequence of acoustically equidistant back vowels.

12. For Cardinal **ɑ** the lips are neutrally open. Cardinal **o** has fairly close lip rounding. For Cardinal **u** the lip rounding is closer still.

13. The positions of the tongue for Cardinal **i, a, ɑ,** and **u** have been determined by X-ray photographs. By marking the highest parts of the tongue with dots in these photographs, their positional relationships have been found, upon which has been constructed the Cardinal Vowel Diagram. Upon a modification of this diagram is based the conventional Vowel Figure.



Vowel Figure showing Primary Cardinal Vowels

Classification of Consonants

14. Consonants have a twofold classification according to (i) the organs employed in their articulation, and (ii) the manner in which they are articulated.

15. Under (i) the following classes are distinguished :

Class		Organs with which articulated
Bilabial	:	both lips, e.g. *b*, *p*.
Labio-dental	:	lower lip and upper front teeth, e.g. Engl. *f*, *v*.
Dental	:	blade of tongue and teeth, e.g. Engl. *th* in ' think '.
Alveolar	:	tip of tongue and teeth-ridge, e.g. *d*, *n*, *l* in ' do not leave '.
Palatal	:	front of tongue and hard palate, e.g. Engl. *y* in ' year '.
Velar	:	back of tongue and soft palate, e.g. *g* in ' go ', *c* in ' come '.
Glottal	:	the glottis, *h*.

16. Distinguished under (ii) according to manner of articulation are the following classes :

Plosive	:	formed by closure of the air passage followed by release, e.g. *p*, *t*, *k*.
Fricative	:	formed by narrowing of the passage continuously with friction, e.g. *s*, *f*.
Affricate	:	formed by closure of the passage followed by slow release during which friction is audible, = a plosive and fricative combined, e.g. *ch* in ' cheek ' ; phonetic symbol **tʃ**.
Nasal	:	formed by closure of the air passage in the mouth while the soft palate is lowered to allow the air to pass freely through the nose, e.g. *m*, *n*.
Lateral	:	formed by obstructing the air passage in the centre of the mouth while leaving the air free to pass at one or both sides of the tongue, e.g. *l*-sounds.
Vibrant	:	formed by tip or blade of tongue making one or more taps against the teeth-ridge, e.g. *r*-sounds.

17. A further distinction is made between voiced and voiceless consonants according to whether there is or is not vibration of the vocal chords during articulation.

Phonemes

18. It has been found that in any language speech sounds related in character group themselves into families. To such a family the name phoneme is given. The members of a phoneme occur in complementary distribution, that is to say that in a particular phonetic context one member is used to the exclusion of other members, while in a different context another member is employed, and no one member is ever used in a situation that is appropriate to another. When a difference in sound is sufficient to denote a difference in meaning, then the difference is ' significant', and the different sounds belong to two separate phonemes. If we take the two types of *l*-sounds occurring in the Irish words *buile* and *buille* as pronounced in Connacht, the first palato-alveolar and the second alveo-palatal, we find that the very meanings of the words are distinguished by the quality of the *l*-sounds. Again in *asal* and *asail* the plural is distinguished from the singular by a difference in the quality of the *l*. This difference is ' significant ' ; meaning depends on it; it is the difference between one and several donkeys. Therefore the *l*'s in this case must belong to different phonemes. Sounds grouped within one phoneme in one language may belong to two or more different phonemes in another. Native speakers of Irish when speaking English often observe the phoneme usage of Irish. This usage, too, may be observed in the English of districts where Irish has long ago ceased to be spoken. Irish unites in one phoneme /**a**/ two or more speech sounds which belong to separate phonemes in Standard English.

19. The latitude allowed in the pronunciation of *ea-*, *a-* in the open initial syllable of words such as *eaglais, Acaill/Eacaill, asal, eanach*, etc., is well known to students of Irish. The reason is

that, in the West and South at least, both *ea-* and *a-* in initial position represent the same phoneme. There is no ' significant ' difference between them, no difference that ' matters ' to the native speaker, who probably does not hear any difference. But the learner in whose speech these two types of *a*-sound belong to two different phonemes hears the difference, and, perhaps, wrongly attaches some importance to it.

20. Phonetic classifications are of necessity based upon and established from the speech of one individual, because there may be much variation in the pronunciation of different speakers, even when they belong to the same speech community.

Symbols

21. It is a principle of phonemic transcription to assign a separate symbol, not to each speech sound, but to each phoneme only. This is known as ' broad ' transcription. It reduces the number of symbols needed to the minimum, since only ' significant ' differences are noted.

22. The symbols employed in this work are those of the International Phonetic Association. A few, viz. **ʟ, ɴ** for dentals, and **ʟ′, ɴ′** for palatals, have been taken over from Quiggin and other later workers in the field of Irish Phonetics[1]. The mark ′ placed after a consonant indicates palatalization of such consonant, e.g. **bʹiɴ′** *binn*. Where palatalized consonants occur in a group or cluster the palatalization mark ′ is placed after the last consonant of the group only. This indicates palatalization of the whole group. There are exceptions to this rule, however, which should be carefully noted. In the seven groups **sm′ sb′ xd′ rd′ rt′ rɴ′ rʟ′** the second consonant only is palatalized. It is not necessary to place the palatalization mark ′ after **ʃ, ç, j**.

23. The bar ˈ placed before a syllable indicates that the chief stress is on such syllable. Secondary stress is shown by ˌ e.g. **ˈklax,wo:n′**. In Erris Irish stress is regularly on the first syllable, and it is usually left unmarked throughout the work. **:** placed after a vowel denotes that such a vowel is long. **·** denotes a half-long vowel, whenever it is required to indicate half-length.

[1] The symbol **ɣ**, normally used here for velar voiced fricative, is slightly different in form from the IPA symbol. Another form of this symbol, viz. **ɣ**, has been used sporadically in place of **ɣ**, e.g. on pp. 72—132, and again from p. 172 to the end. No phonetic or phonemic distinction is implied thereby.

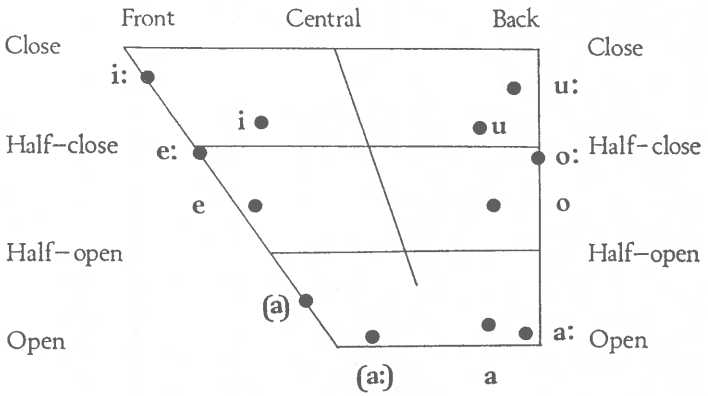
The tilde ~ placed over a vowel symbol indicates nasalization of such vowel. In a stressed syllable a vowel adjoining a nasal consonant is normally more or less nasalized, and it is not necessary to employ the tilde over such a vowel to mark nasalization. Slant lines / / enclose symbols denoting phonemes. Angular brackets [ ] enclose merely phonetic (as opposed to phonemic) symbols.

Note—For greater convenience and economy in the chapters that follow, the term palatal will be used to include palatalized consonants as well as true palatals, and similarly the term velar to indicate velarized as well as velar consonants.

Chapter II

PHONETIC DESCRIPTION OF VOWELS

24. Vowel Figure showing the Vowel Phonemes of Erris Irish



The member which occurs between palatals is shown in the case of front vowels, and that which occurs between velars in the case of back vowels. Bracketed letters indicate front members of the **a**-phoneme, described in §§ 49 and 60 respectively.

25. Much variation in Irish vowels occurs. Vowel quality is conditioned by adjoining consonant sounds. While the articulation of consonants is rigid and fixed, vowels are more fluid and elastic as regards the positions they occupy. Usually the variations are backwards and forwards. Adjacent to palatals vowels are drawn to more forward positions ; they are drawn to more backward positions when they adjoin velars.

26. There may be relative spreading or contraction of the tongue while it forms speech sounds. Consequently some phoneticians, attaching importance to the degree of contraction in the tongue muscles, distinguish between lax and tense vowels, according to the degree of tongue spreading taking place during their formation. If this distinction has any validity at all, it should apply to a language such as Irish, where the maintenance

of two distinct qualities is fundamental to the whole consonant system and in which consonants affect vowel quality so much. Followed by a velarized consonant a vowel would be lax ; followed by a palatalized consonant it would be tense. The lax vowel would be slightly more open than the tense one, especially in the case of front vowels. However, any such distinction between lax and tense vowels in Irish is only incidental, is entirely without phonemic significance, and may therefore be disregarded.

27. ' In languages where there are consistent relationships between vowel length and vowel quality, two vowel qualities may be considered as belonging to a single phoneme, the quality being conditioned by the length.'[1] Long and short members of Irish vowel families do not have exactly the same quality, but, since difference of length going with difference of quality is constant, both are taken as belonging to the same phoneme, following the principle laid down above.

28. The basic vowels of Erris Irish are **i e a o u.** When the feature of length is added the five corresponding long vowels are **i: e: a: o: u:**. With the addition of the feature of nasalization we have five nasalized vowels, thus **ĩ ẽ ã õ ũ**. Corresponding to these with the additional feature of length are **ĩ: ẽ: ã: õ: ũ:**.

Thus the scheme is

basic	+ zero		= V
basic	+ length	+ zero	= V:
basic	+ nasalization	+ zero	= $\tilde{V}$
basic	+ nasalization	+ length	= $\tilde{V}$:

29. The non-nasalized vowel phonemes are :

/i: i/, /e: e/, /a: a/, /o: o/, /u: u/.

/i:

30. The long members of the /i/ phoneme divide themselves into (i) fully front, and (ii) retracted front vowels.

31. The fully front member is a vowel not quite so close as Cardinal Vowel No. 1 (i). It is formed with spread lips. It occurs initially before a palatal, between palatals, and finally

[1] The Principles of the International Phonetic Association, § 6.

following a palatal. Examples are **i:ʃəʟ** *iseal*, **i:v'ɪn'** *aoibhinn*, **m'i:l'ə** *míle*, **m'i:n'** *mín*, **ʃi:n'** *sín*, **f'i:d'o:g** *fídeóg*, **ɴ'i:l'** *ní fhuil*, **er' dl'i:** *ar dlí*, **sb'i:d'** *spid*, **mir'i:n'əx** *muiríneach*, **kal'i:n'** *cailín*, **ə ŋaʟ'i:** *i nGaillimh*, **selt'i:** *soillte*, **ʟ'e:n'i:** *léine*, **gaʃg'i:** *gaisgidhigh*, **er' ə çe:l'i:** *ar a chéile*, **ugɪn'i:** *againne*, **ek'i:** *aice*, **t'e:r'i:** *téirigh*, **b'e:l'i:** *béile*, **axin'i:** *athchuinghe*, **sə ŋan'i:** *sa ngainimh*.

32. Followed by a velar a slightly less close and probably more lax variety of front **i:** occurs, e.g. **i:nəx** *aonach*, **i:ɴtəx** *iongantach*, **i:l** *aol*, **ʃi:s** *síos*, **f'i:do:r'** *figheadóir*, **d'i:su:** *d'íosadh*, **ʃi:l** *síol*, **b'i:ɴ** *bíonn*, **ʃi:xa:n'** *síothcháin*.

33. For retracted **i:** the front of the tongue is raised towards the hard palate, but it is the back part of the front of the tongue that is highest. This **i:** is more open in quality than fully front **i:**. The lips are spread. It occurs preceded by a velar, e.g. **mi:n'** *maoin*, **fi:l'ə wõ:r** *faoile mhór*, **fi:ʟ'a:n** *faoilleán*, **bi:t'ə** *baoite*, **koki:ʃ** *caoicdhighis*, **smi:ʃ** *smaois*, **sgi:l'** *sgaoil*, **sokri:d'** *sochraide*, **ki:n'u:** *caoineadh*, **mi:ʃ** *Maoise*, **a: ri:ʟ'ə** *Ó Raghailligh*, **f'adi:l'** *feadghail*, **di:v'** *daoibh*, **ori:** *oraibh*, **sa:sdi:** *sásta*, **gadi:** *gadaighe*, **ə wãdi:** *a mhadaidh*, **m'e:ri:** *méara*, **kurhi:** *curtha*, **daʟti:** *dallta*, **trə'hno:ni:** *tráth nóna*, **ʃevɴ'e:ri:** *siúinéir*, **sasəɴi:** *Sasana*, **tari:** *tarraidh*. In final open position in an unstressed syllable this **i:** is diphthongized in the speech of some (= **oi** or **əi**). This diphthongization, however, is more a characteristic of the speech of the younger generation of Inishkea Island folk. Sb did not diphthongize in such cases.

34. Between velars **i:** is slightly more open still, and is perhaps also more lax.

Examples—**ki:rə** *caora*, **ki:nəx** *caonach*, **fi:x** *faocha*, **er' mi:s** *ar maos*, **bli:sg** *blaosg*, **bi:l** *baoghal*, **fi:ʟ** *fuidheall*, **ki:l** *caol*, **mi:r** *maor*, **kari:s** *Carghas*, **uni:s** *Aonghus*, **gi:wər** *gaobhar*, **ɴi:sg** *naosg*, **bi:xəs** *buidheachas*.

i/

35. Three short members of the /i/ phoneme occur in stressed syllables. The first lies at about two thirds of the distance from the close to the half-close line. It is considerably retracted from the fully front line. It is closer and slightly more forward than the vowel in Southern English ' kid ', ' pit '. This **i** is found initially before a palatal, and between palatals, e.g. **ʃin'ə** *sine*, **m'in'** *mín*, **ʃʟ'ig'a:n** *sligéan*, **d'ihn'u:r** *deichneabhar*, **il'a:n** *oiléan*, **iʃə** *ise*, **t'ig'** *tig*, **l'ɪn'** *linn*, **er' m'iʃg'ə** *ar meisge*, **d'ɪʟ'o:g** *duilleóg*, **ʃɪn'im'** *seinm*, **im'** *im*, **ə m'ilt'** *ag meilt*, **sm'ig'** *smeig*, **d'ɪn'e:r** *dinnéar*, **ʟ'ihn'əxd** *leithneacht*. This vowel is also heard where **d, t,** or **s** precedes and a palatal follows, e.g. **din'ə** *duine*, **er' ə tɪn'** *ar an tuinn*, **sim'** *suim*. It likewise occurs where a palatal precedes and **s** follows, e.g. **f'is** *fios*, **ɴ'isgo:d'** *neasgóid*, **m'isga:n** *measgán*.

36. When preceded by a palatal and followed by a velar, a more retracted and more open **i** occurs.

Examples — **ʃd'ifa:n** *Stiofán*, **ɪntu:** *ionnta*, **g'insi:** *ag ionnsaighe*, **bə k'ɪnti:** *ba ciontaidhe*, **dr'ipa:s** *driopás*, **g'iri:** *geirrfhiadh*,[1] **pr'insə** *prionnsa*, **hɪnti:** *thionntaigh*, **ə br'iŋlo:d'i:** *ag brionglóidigh*, **g'ira:n** *gearrán*, **f'ɪnhu:** *fionnfadh*, **f'ɪn** *Fionn*, **ʃg'ibo:l** *sgióból*, **b'iʟə** *biolla*, **b'irʟə** *biolar*. All the above examples in this paragraph have an alternative pronunciation in which **i** is replaced by an advanced **u**, e.g. **ʃd'ufa:n, ʊntu:, g'unsi:**, etc. In these it is a case of overlapping of two vowel phonemes between consonants of opposite quality.

37. Following the velars **b, p, f, g, k, m, ʟ, r,** and preceding a palatal, a retracted **i** rather similar to the vowel described in § 36 occurs.

Examples—**kid'** *cuid*, **mid'** *muid*, **drim'** *druim*, **bɪn'əx** *buinneach*, **kɪn'o:g** *cuinneóg*, **bil'i:n'** *builín*, **mint'ir'** *muinntir*, **trip'e:d** *truipéad*, **fiʃo:g** *fuiseóg*, **brit'i:n'əx** *bruittíneach*, **ʟimr'əx** *Luimneach*, **kin'i:n'** *coinín*, **k'ark iʃg'** *cearc uisge*, **giv'ə** *guidhe*, **kir'** *cuir*, **ʟipr'i:n'** *lucharpán*, **kiʃʟ'a:n** *caisléan*. The last three examples here have an equally common alternative pronunciation in which an advanced **u** is substituted for **i**, thus: **kur', ʟupr'i:n', kuʃʟ'a:n**. In sandhi **u** may be heard to replace **i** in *cuid*, *muid*, e.g. **kud do:** *cuid dó*, **hug mud do: e:** *thug muid dó é*. Conversely, **i** sporadically replaces **u** in *ann* (unstressed) **ɪn/ʊn**, *pronntanas* (< *bronntanas*) **prɪntənəs/prʊntənəs**, *bradán* **brida:n/bruda:n**.

38. In unstressed syllables short **i** is a centralized vowel to be placed about the half-close line, when it occurs between palatals, but is more open and retracted, that is to say more central, when a velar precedes it.

Examples—(i) – between palatals – **ker'ib'** *coirb*, **fa:rɴ'iʃ**

[1] Also **g'eri:** (MMt).

fáirnis, **han'ik'** *tháinig/chonnaic*, **kat'il'i:n'** *Caitlín*, **ʃim'il'e:r** *simnéar*, **sder'im'** *stoirm*; (ii) – with a velar preceding – **fa:gim'** *fágbhaim*, **ʃaxin'** *seachain*, **e:miɴ'** *a Éamuinn*.

39. For all varieties of short **i** the lips are somewhat spread, or spread to neutral.

/e:

40. The principal long member of the /**e**/phoneme is a half-close vowel very near to Cardinal Vowel No. 2 in quality, perhaps slightly more open. Lips are spread, though not so spread as for **i:**. **e:** occurs initially before a palatal, between palatals, and finally following a palatal.

Examples—**e:r'ə** *Éire*, **e:ʃd'əxd** *éisteacht*, **e:d'u:** *éideadh*, **e:ɴ'ə** *aon-duine*, **e:r'i:** *éirigh*, **b'e:d'ir'** *b'éidir*, **he:d'** *shéid*, **t'e:gl'ə** *téigle*, **ʟ'e:m'** *léim*, **he:n'** *féin*, **m'e:** *mé*, **ʃe:** *sé*, **kr'e:** *cré*, **ə'ɴ'e:** *ané*, **g'e:** *géadh*.

41. When followed by a velar, **e:** is slightly more open as in the following examples: **e:d** *éad*, **e:dəx** *éadach*, **e:n** *éan*, **e:sgi:** *éasgaidh*, **d'e:rhiɴ'** *adéarainn*, **v'e:rhi:** *bhéaraidh*, **m'e:r** *méar*, **g'e:r** *géar*, **g'e:g** *géag*, **f'e:so:g** *féasóg*, **f'e:sdə** *féasta*, **ʃe:nu:** *séanadh*, **k'e:xd** *céacht*, **f'e:x** *féach*, **kr'e:xdəx** *créachtach*, **ple:sgu:** *pléasgadh*, **k'e:su:** *céasadh*, **gr'e:si:** *gréasaighe*, **bl'e:n** *bléan*, **k'e:d** *céad*, **ãf'e:lə** *aithmhéala*, **d'iɴ'e:r** *dinnéar*, **v'e:s** *bhias*.

42. A retracted long member of the /**e**/phoneme occurs in a limited number of words following a velar, e.g. **ʟe:** *lae*, **re:t'əx** *réiteach*, **ge:lg'ə** *Gaoidhealg*, **fi: re:r'** *faoi réir*, **fore:** *forae*, **pəuse:** *pabhsae*, **kuɴde:** *cunntae*; and between velars, e.g. **ə te:r** *an t-aiéar*, **pe:l** *pael*, **re:ʟt** *réalta*, **ge:l** *Gaoidheal*, **ɣa:re:g** *dhá-fhear-dhéag*.

43. In verse **e:** frequently replaces retracted **i:**, e.g. **ke:l** *caol*, **kre:wo:g'i:n'** *craobhóigín*, **te:w** *taobh*. **e:** is heard in one pronunciation of *aon* **e:n**.

e/

44. The principal short member of the /**e**/phoneme is a front vowel nearly midway between the half-close and the half-open position but slightly nearer to the half-close. It resembles Southern English **ɛ** as in 'pet' but is closer. Lips are partly spread. It occurs initially before a palatal, between palatals, or between a palatal and **h**.

Examples—**er'** *air*, **eg'ə** *aige*, **ed'ir'** *idir*, **eʃi:n'** *Oisín/oisín*, **ef'ig'i:** *oifigigh*, **ebr'u:** *oibriughadh*, **ed'əs** *oideas*, **el'int'** *fhulang*, **er'i:/e:r'i:** *éirghe*, **eʃən** *eisean*, **eʃd'** *eist*, **ebl'əga:d'əx** *oibleagáideach*, **ʃer'** *soir*, **sbl'ek'** *spleic*, **ʃg'elp'** *sgeilp*, **k'eʃd'** *ceist*, **f'ed'il'** *fidil*, **ʟ'et'ir'** *leitir*, **sb'er'** *speir*, **t'ehu:** *teitheadh*, **ə l'ehid'ə ʃo** *a leithéid seo*, **ʃetr'əx** *seitreach*, **kl'et'ə** *cleite*, **p'el'u:r** *piliúr*, **hr'ehu:/hr'ohu:** *threabhfadh*, **m'er'ig'əx** *meirgeach*, **v'ehiɴ'** *bheinn*, **ʟ'eçe:d** *leith-chéad*, **tr'eʃ** *treise*, **bo: heʃg'** *bó sheisg*, **m'ehəl** *meitheal*, **v'eh** *bheith*, **d'eç** *deich*, **f'ehu:** *feitheamh*, **d'er'u:** *deireadh*, **kr'ed'u:** *creideamh*, **k'eʈi:** *Ceití*.

45. A more open and more retracted variety of **e** occurs before non-palatal **r**, e.g. **b'erəx** *bearach*, **b'ert'** *beirt*, **k'erd'/k'ord'** *ceird*; and **g**, e.g. **b'eg** *beag*.

46. A rather retracted short **e** occurs preceded by a velar and followed by a palatal or by **h**.

Examples—**sgel'** *sgoil*, **ser'iv'** *soirbh*, **del'i:** *doiligh*, **tet'** *toit*, **er' ə greç** *ar an gcroich*, **gevɴ'i:** *goibhne*, **selʃə** *soillse*, **gevl'ə marə** *gaibhle mara*, **treç** *troigh*, **wet'** *uait*, **weçə** *uaithe*, **der'u: i:** *doireadh í*, **rehə** *reithe*, **hreʃg'** *throisg*, **seʟ'** *soill*, **tred'** *troid*, **tebr'əxi:** *toibreacha*, **ʟel'i:x** *loilgheach*, **sev'ir'** *saidhbhir*, **ged'** *goid*, **tevʃə** *taidhbhse*, **drehəd** *droichead*, **kerk'ə** *coirce*, **kerp'** *coirp*, **debr'i:** *d'oibrigh*, **del'iɴ'** *d'fhulaing*, **teʃəx ə tehi:** *toiseach an tsoithigh*, **keʟ'** *coill*, **der'ə** *Doire*, **meʟ'** *moill*, and frequently in *raibh*, e.g. **ɴ'i: re ʃe: aɴ** *ní raibh sé ann*. An advanced variety of **o** frequently replaces this **e** in *coirce*, *coill*, *reithe*, *raibh*, *sgoil*.

47. Following **s** or **r** retracted **e** often replaces **o** in **sost/sest** *sost*, **sotəl/setəl** *sotal*, **krotəx/kretəx** *crotach*; preceding **s** in **osnə/esnə** *osna*; and preceding **r** in **dorəs/derəs** *dorus*, **toru:/teru:** *turadh*, and in the phrase **hori:t/heri:t** (*do*) *shoraidh dhíot*.

a/

48. The /**a**/phoneme occupies a large area in vowel space. Its range is wide. It comprises among its members a number of quite distinct speech sounds. These fall roughly into two groups, viz. open front vowels and back vowels, which in a narrow transcription would be denoted by the symbols **a** and **ɑ** respectively. Here since they are all members of the same phoneme they are transcribed as **a**. Numerous shades of **a**

occur merging into one another with no sharp line of demarcation dividing them.

49. The closest member of the /**a**/phoneme is heard when preceded by one of the non-palatals **d**, **t**, **s**, **r**, **n** and followed by a palatal or by **h**. This is a short front vowel lying about midway between the open and half-open positions. It resembles Southern English **æ** as in ' hat ', ' sash ', but is perhaps closer and seems to have wider jaw opening. Lips are neutral.

Examples are **sal'** *sail*, **sdal'** *stail*, **sdad'e:r** *stuidéar*, **daŋ'ən** *daingean*, **graçəx** *gnoaightheach*, **daʟ'** *daill*, **dahn'i:** *d'aithnigh*, **əs at'** *is ait*, **rud aʃd'əx** *réad aisteach*, **kraɴ'** *crainn*, **bun əɴ alt'** *bun an ailt*, **ku:rt' əɴ ahi:** *cúirt an fhathaigh*, **dalt'ən** *dailtean*.

50. Initially before a palatal and between palatals this close **a** or a vowel nearly as close is heard.

Examples—**amʃir'** *aimsir*, **aml'u:** *aimleadh*, **gə hab'e:l'** *go haibéil*, **er' aʃ** *ar ais*, **er' at'i:s** *ar fhaitcheas*.

51. The second member of the /**a**/phoneme is an open vowel occupying a position near to but something closer than Cardinal Vowel No. 4 (**a**). This vowel occurs preceded by a palatal or by **r** and followed by one of the non-palatals **d**, **t**, **s**.

Examples—**k'ad** *cead*, **l'at** *leat*, **ʃas** *seas*, **bradəx** *bradach*, **d'as** *deas*, **er' ati:** *ar fhatai*.

52. When a non-palatal other than **d**, **t**, **s** follows, a more retracted **a**, that is to say a vowel occupying a position slightly retracted from Cardinal Vowel No. 4 position, is heard. It is a more open vowel than that described in the previous paragraph.

Examples—**m'akən** *meacan*, **g'al** *geal*, **ʟ'ag** *leag*, **aku:ɴ'** *acmhaing*, **f'aɴti:** *feannta*, **g'aləka:n** *gealacán*, **gr'aɴu:r** *greannmhar*, **b'aləx** *bealach*, **k'ap** *ceap*, **g'axdə** *Geachta*, **ʃarəx** *searrach*, **b'art** *beart*, **br'ak** *breac*, **k'art** *ceart*, **d'aləg** *dealg*, **ahla:n** *athlán*.

53. Preceded by one of the palatals **t'**, **d'**, **n'**, **ʃ** and followed by **x** the position of **a** is still more retracted.

Examples—**t'ax** *teach*, **gə n'axi:** *go ndeachaidh*, **ʃn'axdə** *sneachta*, **ʃaxd** *seacht*. For this **a** a back variety **a** is often substituted in these words. The same vowel instability may be observed in words in which **m**, **w**, **n**, **ŋ**, or **g** follows **a**, preceded by a palatal, e.g. **dr'am** *dream*, **g'ãwər** *geamhar*, **ʃʟ'ãwin'** *sleamhain*, **k'aɴ** *ceann*, **p'aɴ** *peann*, **t'aŋi:** *teanga*, **ʃagəl** *seagal*.

54. The next member in order of retraction is a short open vowel near, but in advance of, and slightly less open than Cardinal Vowel No. 5. The back of the tongue is raised but the raising is very slight. Lips are neutral. This vowel sound occurs initially before a velar, between velars, between a velar and **h**, and finally following a velar in monosyllables.

Examples—**arka:n** *arcán*, **n'i: akəs** *ní fhacthas*, **akiʟ'** *Acaill*, **anəm** *anam*, **aʟt** *alt*, **əg agni:xd** *ag eagnaidheacht*, **asəl** *asal*, **asərʟi:xd** *asarlaigheacht*, **ag** *eag*, **falu:** *falamh*, **baxlo:g** *bachlóg*, **kapəʟ** *capall*, **garʟə** *galar*, **bali:** *balaighthe*, **maŋəx** *mangach*, **ə waləx** *i bhfalach*, **farig'ə** *fairrge*, **klaxwo:n'** *clach-mhóin*, **mahəs** *maitheas*, **kahu:** *caitheamh*, **bah** *ba*.

55. Initially the **a** just described in the previous paragraph may alternate with the front variety **a** described in § 52 in such words as *eag*, *asal*, *arcán*, *Acaill*. The quality is often determined by the nature of the final consonant in the preceding word. Cf. § 19 above.

56. When a palatal follows, a slightly more advanced **a** than the **a** described in § 54 occurs, e.g. **kaç** *caith*, **mad'ə** *maide*, **kalt'ər** *cailltear*, **gan'u:** *gaineamh*, **bal'ə** *baile*, **bantr'əx** *baintreabhthach*, **gaʃg'i:x** *gaisgidheach*, **fat'i:s** *faitcheas*, **sbalp'i:n'** *spailpín*, **kant'** *cainnt*, **kat'** *cait*, **klag'əɴ** *claigeann*, **mar'ig'** *mairg*, **kaʟ'əx** *cailleach*, **sʟaɴ'u:** *sloinneadh*, **baɴ'ə** *bainne*, **flaçəs** *flaitheas*.

/**a:**

57. The principal long member of the /**a**/phoneme is an open back vowel whose position is practically that of Cardinal Vowel No. 5, or very slightly in advance of it. The lips are neutrally open and there is good jaw opening. This **a:** occurs in all positions except where a palatal precedes or follows.

Examples are **a:** *ó/Ó*, **a:rd** *ard*, **a:rd'** *aird*, **ba:d** *bád*, **ga:ri:**/**gari:** *garrdha*, **ha:ʟ** *thall*, **ə'na:ʟ** *anall*, **sa:x** *sáthach*, **sa:ri:** *sáraigh*, **ʟa:** *lá*, **ma:nəs** *Maghnus*, **i:çə ra:niʟ'** *oidhche Raghnaill*, **na:** *nó*, **ər ba:ʟ** *ar ball*, **pa:ga:nəx** *págánach*, **ta:rha:l'** *tarrtháil*, **ta:rɣad** *tarr-ghad*.

58. When followed by a palatal the vowel is slightly more advanced and perhaps less open than that described in the previous paragraph.

Examples—**a:r'i:** *áiridh*, **ə ga:r'i:** *ag gáire*, **fa:l'** *fagháil*, **da:r'** *dáir*, **ʃi:xa:n'** *síothcháin*.

59. A still more advanced **a:**, that is to say a vowel occupying a position more in advance of Cardinal Vowel No. 5, is heard when a palatal immediately precedes.

Examples are **f'a:** *feadha*, **b'a:rɴi:** *bearna*, **ə ʟ'a:w** *ag leaghadh*, **ʟ'a:mi:** *leaghma*, **ʃɴ'a:** *sneadh*, **br'a:** *breaghdha*, **ja:r** *ghearr*, **ɴ'i: ja:rɴi:** *ní dhearna*, **br'a:n** *biorán*, **k'a:rdi:** *ceardaighe*, **ʃa:nu:** *taisbéanadh*, **m'a:xən** *meadhachan*, **f'a:n** *feadhan*, **ʃʟ'a:n** *sleaghán*, **ʃa:n** *Seaán*.

60. A retracted open front vowel having the quality of the vowel described in § 52 but long, occurs as a diaphonic variant of the vowel just described in § 59, when preceded by a palatal and followed by (i) zero, (ii) **r**, (iii) **x**.

Examples are **br'a:** *breaghdha*, **f'a:** *feadha*, **f'a:r** *fearr*, **g'a:r** *gearr*, **b'a:rɴi:** *bearna*, **m'a:xən** *meadhachan*. This same variation takes place in the case of the words **a:** *ó*, **ɴa:** *nó/ná*.

o/

61. There are two short members of the /**o**/phoneme. The first is a vowel somewhat advanced from the back line, and occupying a position between the half-open and half-close line, nearer perhaps to the latter. It has slight lip-rounding. It occurs initially before a velar, between velars, and between a velar and **h.**

Examples are **olk** *olc*, **oxir'** *eochair*, **olə** *ola*, **ordi:** *ordaigh*, **bog** *bog*, **bolɵg** *bolg*, **boxiʟ'** *buachaill*, **kokə** *coca*, **koxən** *cochan*, **koləpə tali:** *colpa talaimh*, **kohrəm** *comhthrom*, **dorəs** *dorus*, **fosgil'** *fosgail*, **ʟofi:** *lobhtha*, **roha:n** *rothán*, **soləs** *solus*, **sosdəx** *sostach*, **sgornəx** *sgornach*, **sdodə** *stoda*, **torʃəx** *tuirseach*, **torɴ'əx** *toirneach*, **torɴo:g** *tornóg*, **trosg** *trosg*, **toxəs** *tochas*, **tro ɴə koʃə** *troigh na coise*. This vowel also occurs following a palatal and preceding **x**, e.g. **d'ox** *deoch*, **fl'ox** *fliuch*, **ʃoxra:n** *seachrán*.

62. The second member differs from the first in being more advanced. Its position is somewhere about midway between the back and centre line. It occurs following a velar and before a palatal.

Examples are **koʟ'** *coill*, **doʃi:n'** *doisín*, **gor'i:n'** *goirín*, **kork'ə** *coirce*, **loʃg'** *loisg*, **sovr'iʃd'i:** *soi-bhriste*, **toʃi:** *toisigh*. **e** (described in § 46) is frequently substituted for **o** in the words given in this paragraph as examples. Thus **koʟ'/keʟ', doʃi:n'/deʃi:n'**, etc. are used indifferently by Erris speakers in general, with overlapping of the vowel phonemes between consonants of opposite quality. The same alternation **o/e** occurs following a palatal and preceding a velar in **b'og/b'eg** *beag*, and **k'ord'/k'erd'** *ceird*; and preceding **h** in **hr'ohu:/hr'ehu:** *threabhfadh*.

/o:

63. The first long member of the /**o**/phoneme is a half-close back vowel very near Cardinal Vowel No. 7 in quality. It has fairly close lip-rounding. It occurs initially before a velar, between velars, and finally following a velar.

Examples are **o:g** *óg*, **o:l** *ól*, **o:ra:n** *amhrán*, **bro:x** *brodhach*, **daʟo:g** *dallóg*, **fo:s** *phós*, **to:rt'** *tabhairt*, **to:rhu:** *tórramh*, **anro:** *annró*, **bo:** *bó*, **do:** *dódh*, **t'uɴto:** *tionntódh*, **t'umpo:** *iompódh*.

64. When followed by a palatal, **o:** is something closer.

Examples—**blago:d'** *blagóid*, **ko:ʃd'ə** *cóiste*, **k'aho:d'əx** *ceathóideach*, **do:ju:l'** *dóigheamhail*, **ə go:l' ə wa:d'** *ag gabháil an bháid*, **gro:g'u:** *gróigeadh*, **ʟo:ʃd'i:n'** *lóistín*, **uno:r'** *onóir*, **po:r'hi:n'** *póirín*, **to:g'** *tóg*, **to:r'** *tabhair*, **tr'iblo:d'** *trioblóid*.

65. Preceded by a palatal a more advanced **o:** occurs, e.g. **b'o:** *beó*, **k'o:** *ceó*, **gə d'o:** *go deó*, **f'o:l'** *feóil*, **f'o:lim'** *foghlaim*, **ʃo:l** *seól*.

u/

66. **u** occupies a position closer than the half-close line and advanced from the back line. Lips are rounded. It occurs initially before a velar and between velars, e.g. **umir'ə** *iomaire*, **ugəm** *agam/chugam*, **ugəsdu:n** *ugastún*, **unsə** *unnsa*, **umpər** *iomchar*, **una:s** *anás*, **uno:r'** *onóir*, **uməda:n** *amadán*, **umərki:** *iomarcaidh*, **uŋə** *ionga*, **una:l'** *anáil*, **umru:** *iomramh*, **bruda:n** *bradán*, **kuplə** *cupla*, **dunə** *dona*, **ə ŋunəsd** *i ngan-fhios*, **ʟufa:r'** *lúth-ghair*, **ʟuɴduf** *londubh*, **muka:ɴtəs** *macántas*, **rubəʟ** *earball*, **ruɴəx** *ronnach*, **rud** *réad*, **rumpu:/ro:mpu:** *rompa*, **sbura:n** *sparán*, **sguda:n** *sgadán*, **ʃruŋa:n** *sreangán*, **tumbə** *tomba*, **tugəɴ** *tugann*.

67. A more advanced variety of **u** occurs when a palatal follows, e.g. **muʃə** *muise*, **puʃi:n'** *puisín*, **kluf'ə** *cluiche*, **ʟupr'i:n'** *lucharpán*, **ə xuʃʟ'ə** *a chuisle*, **punt'ə** *poinnte*.

68. When a palatal precedes, **u** is perhaps slightly more advanced still, e.g. **ʃg'uʟa:n** *sgeallán*, **ʃuŋa:n** *seangán*, **d'ula:n d'e:** *dealán dé*, **p'uku:** *piocadh*, **f'uɴ** *fionn/Fionn*, **f'uɴhu:** *fionnfadh*, **t'unto:** *tionntódh*, **tr'umu:** *tiormughadh*, **ə g'uɴ** *i gcionn*, **ə'ɴ'uf** *aniogh*, **ə ŋ'uʟ er'** *i ngioll ar*; it is almost a fully central vowel in **b'uʟi: gan'i:** *biollaí gainmhe*, **(kuma:n) m'uʟə** *comán mionla*. In the case of most of the words cited in this paragraph in which a nasal or lateral follows **u**, there is variation between **u** and **i** with overlapping of allophones of different phonemes, thus:

ʃg'uʟa:n/ʃg'iʟa:n, **ʃuŋa:n/ʃiŋa:n**,
d'ula:n/d'ila:n, **f'uɴ/f'iɴ**,
t'unto:/t'into:, **tr'umu:/tr'imu:**,
b'uʟi:/b'iʟi:, **kuma:n m'uʟə/m'iʟə**.

So, too, **b'ur/b'ir** *bior*.

/u:

69. The principal long member of the /**u**/phoneme is a back vowel more open in quality than Cardinal Vowel No. 8. It has close lip-rounding. It occurs initially before a velar, between velars, and finally following a velar.

Examples—**u: baɴ'ə** *úth bainne*, **u:da:s** *Iúdás*, **u:dər** *ughdar*, **u:r** *úr*, **aru:r** *arbhar*, **b'aru:x** *bearradhach*, **b'ahu:x** *beathadhach*, **baru:ləx** *baramhlach*, **ku:r** *cubhar*, **k'iəʟu:r** *ciallmhar*, **faru:x kruəçə** *faradhach cruaiche*, **gr'aɴu:r** *greannmhar*, **m'e:nhu:x** *méanfadhach*, **pa:rʟu:s** *parlús*, **ru:mə** *rúma*, **oru:s** *urradhas*, **tr'u:r** *triúr*, **tu:rɴ'ə** *túirne*, **banu:** *banbh*, **koru:** *corraighe*, **koʟu:** *codladh*, **dru:** *dorgha*, **dlu:** *dlúth*, **fasgu:** *fasgadh*, **ga:lu:** *gála*, **garu:** *garbh*, **madu:** *madadh*, **orhu:** *ortha*, **sgahu:** *sgathamh*, **talu:** *talamh*, **taru:** *tarbh*, **tu:** *tú*.

70. Followed by a palatal, **u:** is more advanced and slightly closer, e.g. **aku:ɴ'əx** *acmhaingeach*, **baru:l'** *baramhail*, **ku:g'** *cúig*, **iɴ'u:n'** *inneóin*, **ʟa:nu:n'** *lánamhain*, **ʟ'anu:nt'** *leanmhain*, **su:l'** *súil*, **su:ʃd'ə** *súiste*.

71. Likewise when a palatal precedes, the more advanced variety of **u:** is heard.

Examples—**b'e:k'u:x** *béicfeadhach*, **br'iʃu:** *briseadh*, **kaʟ'u:** *cailleadh*, **k'in'u:** *cineadh*, **kr'ed'u:** *creideamh*, **d'er'u:** *deireadh*, **gan'u:** *gaineamh*, **glan'u:** *gloineadha*, **ʃin'u:** *sineadha*, **f'u:** *fiú*.

ə

72. **ə** represents a short central, or neutral, vowel, which varies much according to its phonetic context, for adjoining consonants affect its quality. Generally, when it occurs between velars, its position is lower than the half-close line, and it may reach the half-open line. When it precedes or follows a palatal, its position is approaching the half-close line. **ə** occurs in unstressed syllables only. Lips are neutral. Examples with the more open quality **ə** are **ə'max** *amach*, **b'e:l əɴ a:** *Béal an Átha*, **kaləm** *calm*, **karəbəd** *carbad*, **kapəʟ** *capall*, **koləg** *colg*, **hanə** *cheana*, **d'arəməd** *dearmad*, **atəru:** *eatorra*, **f'arəba:n** *fearbán*, **ʟoxə** *loch*, **marəgu:** *margadh*, **gə m'asərə** *go measardha*, **marəfa:ʃg'** *marbh-fáisg*, **i:çə noɪək** *Oidhche Nodlag*, **osnə** *osna*, **pu:kə** *púca*, **ri:xdə** *ríoghdhacht*, **sʟatə marə** *slata mara*, **ʃarəgo: ʃe:** *seargóidh sé*, **t'anəm** *teanam*, **kil'əɴ tra:wə** *cuileann trágha*, **tə'bak** *tobac*.

73. Examples in which the closer variety of **ə** occurs are **ə'r'i:ʃt'** *arís*, **baɴ'ə** *bainne*, **der'ə** *Doire*, **e:r'ə** *Éire*, **ə'ɴ'i:s** *aníos*.

74. The phonemic status of **ə** in Irish has not been established. It would seem that the short unstressed members of the **a-** , **o-** , and **u**-phonemes, with reduction of length, have undergone a change in quality, and overlap in central position as allophones of different phonemes. The Irish Bardic Schools seem to have recognised this centuries ago when they granted full liberty of spelling in unstressed short syllables and wrote, for instance, *agas*, *agos*, and *agus* indifferently, as being equally correct. What Prof. Jones writes on p. 107 of *The Phoneme* has its application here also. He takes the view that English short **ə** might be regarded as a member of two or even more of the English strong vowel phonemes such as **a** or **ʌ**. One is equally well entitled to take the view that Irish short **ə** might be regarded as a member of the **a-** , **o-** , or **u**-phoneme, and in certain cases as a member of the **e**-phoneme.

Nasalized Vowels

75. Nasalized vowels occur adjoining nasal consonants[1], e.g. **ĩ** in *im*, **ã** in *cam*, **ũ** in *bun*. Such nasalization of vowels is incidental to the movements of the soft palate and is non-significant.

[1] See also §§ 206–9.

It is left unmarked in the transcription, as the contiguity of a nasal consonant is sufficient in itself to indicate it. But a nasalized vowel may also occur in a position where no nasal consonant adjoins it. It is this fact which gives such nasalized vowels separate phonemic status, and in transcribing them the tilde is employed.

76. The nasalized phonemes are /**ĩː ĩ**/, /**ẽː ẽ**/, /**ãː ã**/, /**õː õ**/, /**ũː ũ**/.

77. Examples of **ĩː**—**kĩːf'əx** *caoimhtheach*, **gr'ĩːw** *gniomh*, **mrĩː** *mnaoi*.

78. Examples of **ĩ**—**g'ĩvr'uː** *geimhreadh*, **d'ĩv'əs** *deimheas*, **gə d'ĩv'in'** *go deimhin*, **kĩvn'uː** *cuimhniughadh*, **kĩhiːx** *coimhitheach*.

79. Examples of **ẽː**—**m'ẽːrə/m'eːnrə** *méanra*, **mə v'ẽːr** *mo mhéar*.

80. Examples of **ẽ**—**tẽs/tõs** *tomhas*, **tẽʃd'iː** *tomhaiste*.

81. Examples of **ã**—**rãwər** *reamhar*, **gãwin'** *gamhain*, **sãwiː** *samhaidh*, **ə t'ãwir' wĩr'ə** *an tseamair Mhuire*, **ãwliː** *amhlaidh*, **t'iːr' ãwliː** *Tír Amhalghaidh*, **g'ãwər** *geamhar*.

82. Examples of **ãː**—**ãːt'** *áit*, **ʟãːw** *lámh*, **mrãː** *mná*, **sə trãːw** *sa tsnámh*, **mad'ə rãːwə** *maide rámha*, **kãːfəʟ** *camall*.

83. In the speech of Sb and indeed in that of the people of Faulmore in general, and also of Doohoma, a long half-open strongly nasalized vowel quite near in position to Cardinal Vowel No. 6 (ɔ) occurs as a diaphonic variant of fully open **ãː**, especially in the following words :—**mãːrtən** *Mártan*, **səʀ ãːt'** *san áit*, **ə'wãːn'** *amháin*, **prãːntiː** *prántaigh*, **mãːhir'** *máthair*, **d'e mãːrt'** *Dé Máirt*. This variation is not so noticeable in Dû Chaocháin.

84. Examples of **õ** are rare. Two instances at least have been observed, viz. **tõs** *tomhas* and **kõhəruː** *comhartha*.

85. Examples of **õː**—**kõːrʟ'ə** *comhairle*, **rõːt** *romhat*, **kõːrək** *comhrag*, **kõːliː** *comhla*, **rõːwər** *rómhar*, **fõːwər** *foghmhar*, **ə rõːv'** *an Róimh*.

86. Example of **ũ**—**krũk** *cnoc*.

87. Examples of **ũː**—**klũːx** *clúmhach*, **ũːliː** *umhlaigh*, **kũːxdə** *cumhachta*, **dũːjə/dũːiː** *dumhaigh*.

Chapter III

PHONETIC DESCRIPTION OF DIPHTHONGS

88. In forming a diphthong the tongue glides from one vowel position in the direction of another vowel position by the shortest distance and in one impulse of breath. The tongue may not reach the point it is moving towards.

89. In a speech chain sounds are prominent either on account of their inherent sonority, length, stress, pitch, or a combination of these. Where the maximum prominence occurs at the beginning of a diphthong and is falling to the end, the diphthong is described as a falling diphthong. The diphthongs of Erris Irish are in this sense falling diphthongs.

90. A diphthong is described as long or short according to the length of time spent on the glide or movement ; it is termed narrow or wide according to the amount of movement made in going from one position to the other. A diphthong is said to be imperfect when either element is lengthened before or after the tongue movement.

91. Erris Irish has four diphthong phonemes, which are represented by the symbols / **iə uə əi əu** / . These are all falling diphthongs, since in each the first element is the more prominent either because of greater length (in the case of **iə** and **uə**) or greater sonority (in the case of **əi** and **əu**). The first elements of **iə** and **uə** are the long vowels **iː** and **uː** respectively, somewhat shortened.

Except in open final position **iə, uə** are in Erris Irish rather narrow diphthongs, so narrow that they are under-differentiated from the long vowels **iː**, **uː** respectively, particularly preceding a nasal consonant or occurring between consonants that are similar in their point of articulation. **əi** and **əu** have a continuous movement and are therefore to be considered ' perfect ' diphthongs.

/iə/

92. In forming **iə** the tongue starts from the position of front **i:** (as described in § 32) and moves towards a central position between half-close and half-open. When **r** precedes, the starting point is the more retracted **i:** (described in § 33).

93. The principal member of the /**iə**/phoneme is found to occur before a velar or in open final position.

Examples—**b'iə** *biadh*, **br'iən** *Brian*, **kl'iəw** *cliabh*, **kl'īəwin'** *cliamhain*, **d'iə** *Dia*, **f'iə** *fiadh*, **f'iər** *fiar*, **iəri:** *iarraidh*, **iərgu:l'** *iargcúil*, **iəsg** *iasg*, **m'iən** *mian*, **ʃg'iən** *sgian*, **ʃg'iətə** *sgiata*, **tr'iəʟ** *triall*.

94. A second member occurs before a palatal. It has a closer and more advanced vowel for its second element than the first member has.

Examples—**bl'iən'** *bliadhain*, **riəl'** *riaghail*

/uə/

95. There are two almost equally common members of the /**uə**/phoneme. They both have the same starting point at **u:** (i.e. the vowel described in § 69). In the case of the first member the tongue moves towards a central vowel **ə**.

Examples—**ə'ɴuəs** *anuas*, **buətiʃ** *buatais*, **buərhə** *buaidheartha*, **bruəx** *bruach*, **kluəs** *cluas*, **kruəx** *cruach*, **kuərt'** *cuairt*, **fuədi:** *fuadaigh*, **fuəxd** *fuacht*, **guəgəx** *guagach*, **ʟuəxir'** *luachair*, **mad'ə ʟuəsdir'** *maide luastair*, **ruə** *ruadh*, **ruəkən** *ruacan*, **sʟuə** *sluagh*, **huəs** *thuas*, **uəsəl** *uasal*, **uəxdər** *uachtar*.

96. For the second member the tongue moves towards a closer and more fronted central vowel.

Examples—**buək'** *buaic*, **buəl'** *buail*, **kruəj** *cruaidh*, **fuəj** *chuaidh*, **duərk'** *duairc*, **duəʃ** *duais*, **ʟiv' ə toxd uəl'** *luibh an tocht fhuail*, **ruəg'** *ruaig*, **br'a:n suən'** *biorán suain*, **a: huəj** *ó thuaidh*, **uəvr'əx** *uaibhreach*, **uəç** *uaigh*, **uəgn'əx** *uaigneach*, **uəʃʟ'ə** *uaisle*.

/əi/

97. Three principal members of this diphthong phoneme may be distinguished. The first member has its starting point about the half-open line, nearer to the centre than to the front, and moves in the direction of the vowel **i** described in § 35. The words in which it occurs are not numerous.

Examples—**m'əir'əx** *meadhrach*, **d'əir'i:** (beside the much more common **d'e:r'i:** and **d'er'i:**) *d'éirigh* ; in these it is flanked by palatals. In **ʟ'əis** *leigheas* the finishing point of the diphthong is more in the direction of the centre.

98. The second member occurs initially preceding a velar, and between velars. Its first element is a vowel nearer to the centre than to the back line, and on or near the half-open line. The movement is in the direction of a retracted **i** (as described in § 36).

Examples—**əisdər** *adhastar*, **səid** *soighead*, **ʟəir** *ladhar*, **gəir** *gaghar*, **əirk** *adharc*, **rəirk** *radharc*, **sʟəida:n** *slaodán*, **təig** *Tadhg*, **trəin** *traghan*, **əiɴ** *eidhean*.

99. The third differs from the second member in that the tongue movement is in the direction of the vowel **i** described in § 35. It occurs in words where a palatal or **h** follows.

Examples—**əir'ə** *oighre*, **kləir'ə** *cladhaire*, **dəihəxi: f'iəkəl** *doightheacha fiacal*, **fəid'** *foighide*, **fəit'i:n'** *faoitín*, **gr'im' əirk'ə** *greim adhairce*, **səid'u:r** *soighdiúir*.

/əu/

100. There are two members of this diphthong phoneme clearly distinguished. For the first the starting point is somewhere about the half-open, and in advance of the centre, line. This occurs when a palatal precedes. The second member starts from the half-open line and about half way between the back and centre lines. This second member occurs in words in open initial position and following a velar. In both members the movement is towards the position of the vowel **u** as described in § 66.

101. Examples illustrating the first member are **ʟ'əur** *leabhar*, **kr'əur** *creabhar*, **d'əul** *diabhal*, **ʃəuk** *seabhac*, **m'əur'** *meabhair*, **m'əura:n** *meabhrán*, **ʟ'əukə** *leabhra !* **k'əul' ʃe:** *cá bhfuil sé ?*

102. Examples of the second member are **bəur** *bodhar*, **kəuləx** *cabhlach*, **dəun** *domhan*, **gəur** *gabhar*, **ɴ'i: rəus** *ní rabhas*, **səu** *Sadhbh*, **sʟəuru:** *slabhradh*, **təuə/təu** *togha*.

103. **əu** occurs in the trisyllabic word **f'iəurəs** *fiabhras*, preceded by the same **i**, half-long or more, as is in the diphthong **iə** described in § 92.

Chapter IV

PHONETIC DESCRIPTION OF CONSONANTS

Palatalization and Velarization

104. All consonants in Irish, apart from the glottal fricative **h**, have either palatal or velar quality. In this matter of palatal or velar quality they are in contrastive pairs. A consonant whose primary articulation is not palatal, that is to say, a consonant articulated at some point other than against the hard palate, becomes palatalized by a raising of the front of the tongue towards the hard palate simultaneously with the main articulation. Conversely, a consonant is velarized by a raising of the back of the tongue towards the soft palate simultaneously with the main articulation, which is elsewhere. A palatalized consonant has the resonance of a close or half-close front vowel, while a velarized consonant has that of a close or half-close back vowel. Bilabials are clearly contrasted in this regard, so too are alveolars. But the dentals **d**, **ɴ**, **t** have neutral **ə**-quality rather than **u**-quality, yet they are sufficiently distinct in their point of articulation from the corresponding palatals **d′**, **ɴ′**, **t′** to contrast with them in the consonantal system. Similarly **s** is more neutral than velar in quality, yet it contrasts with **ʃ**, the marked palatal quality of the latter making a clear-cut distinction between the two.

Voicing

105. Erris Irish has eleven pairs of consonants both members of each of which are articulated in a similar manner, but with the difference that one of the pair is voiced and the other voiceless. The pairs are (with the voiceless member placed first in each pair) **/p′ b′, p b, t′ d′, ṭ ḍ, t d, k′ g′, k g, f′ v′, f w, ç j, x ɣ/**.

The members of each of these pairs are in phonemic contrast to each other. The laterals, nasals, and vibrants have only voiced forms as regular phonemes. When a *h*-sound precedes a lateral, nasal, or vibrant, its effect is to devoice such lateral, nasal, or vibrant. These devoiced consonants are of restricted distribution. They occur intervocalically in medial position and initially in cases of grammatical lenition. Whether such devoiced consonants are entitled to separate mono-phonemic status is a matter of interpretation. They are in fact omitted from the table of consonant phonemes given at § 114 below. Voiceless **/ʃ, s, h/** have no voiced contrasts in the system.[1]

106. Voiced consonants are fully voiced when they occur in intervocalic position ; they are not fully voiced in initial or in final positions. Initially articulation may begin before voicing, and finally voicing may cease before articulation is finished. Voiceless **/ s, p, t, k, f, x /**, as also **/ ʃ, p′, t′, k′, f′, ç /**, each devoice a following nasal or liquid consonant. Thus for example in the words **smalk′** *smailc*, **sɴi:m′** *snaidhm*, **pr′ab** *preab*, **treç** *troigh*, **kladəx** *cladach*, **fl′ox** *fliuch*, **axrəɴ** *achrann*, **m, ɴ, r′, r, l, l′, r** are each partially devoiced. In certain contexts completely devoiced **l** and **r** occur, as in cases where there is elision of a final vowel at the end of an utterance, e.g. **k′aɴ akl** *Ceann Acla*, **ɴi: ɴakr** *naoi n-acra*. But in a speech chain **l** and **r** in these and other such words retain their normal partial voicing.

107. **m, m′, ŋ, ŋ′**, *n*-sounds, *l*-sounds, and *r*-sounds are partially devoiced by a following voiceless consonant, as for example in **ʟampə** *lampa*, **paŋk** *pangc*, **bant′** *baint*, **aɪt** *alt*, **ort** *ort*.

108. What the proper transcription of plosives following **s, ʃ**, should be is a rather unsettled question in Irish. Modern Irish orthography shows hesitation between *p, t, c*, and *b, d, g*, in such cases, e.g. between *scéal* and *sgéal*, just as it hesitates between *t* and *d* following *ch*, e.g. between *seacht* and *seachd*. Phonetically considered, however, it really amounts to the same whether

[1] **z** is not a normal speech sound of Erris Irish. The writer has observed it only once in Faulmore in the word **g′izda:n** *giosadán* from a member of the generation younger than Sb's. Sb had two pronunciations of this word, viz. **g′isəda:n/g′isda:n**. **ʒ** occurs only in words borrowed from English, e.g. **sʟati: o:ʒər** *slataí osier*, and velarized **ʒ** in the plural of borrowed words ending in **r**, e.g. **ṭe:sdərʒ** *testers*, **ḍəip′ərʒ** *diapers*.

one writes *c* or *g*, *t* or *d*, in such words.[1]

109. Plosives preceded by **s**, **ʃ** are partially voiced in medial position following a stressed vowel, when a vowel follows either in the same word or initially in a word following in close sequence, e.g. *iasgán*, *bhí iasg ann*. Similarly a dental plosive preceded by **x** is partially voiced in the same circumstances, e.g. **uəxdər** *uachtar*, **din'ə boxd aɴ** *duine bocht ann*. Plosives preceded by **s**, **ʃ** in initial position before a stressed vowel are unvoiced, e.g. **sgel'** *sgoil*.

Plosion

110. A plosive consonant must have complete blockage of the air passage at some point. This constitutes the stop, and it is followed by the release, which may be either voiceless or voiced. In Irish voiceless plosives are aspirated when they occur at the beginning of a stressed syllable or in final position. This means that on the release of the stop a faint *h*-sound is perceptible. Plosives preceded by **s**, **ʃ**, or **x**, are unaspirated. In English plosives may be exploded nasally, where the release is through the nose, e.g. *fatten* (where the plosion of **t** is through **n**), or they may be exploded laterally, where the release is via the side or sides, as when an *l*-sound follows, e.g. *nettle*.

111. In Erris Irish independent plosion is usual in word initial, e.g. **dli:** *dlaoi*, **gl'ek'** *glic*. This may at first give the impression of a vowel before the **l**, thus **dəli:**, **gəl'ek'**. Lateral plosion occurs medially following **k**, e.g. **fokli:**, plur. of *focal*, and following **ṭ** in the case of a small number of words, e.g. **karṭliɴ'** *cartlainn*, **k'erṭl'i:n'** *ceirtlín*. Please note that **ṭ** in each of these two examples is alveolar and is articulated in the same place as the **l** that follows. In sandhi positions also, lateral plosion with assimilation of **t'** or **d'** is common, e.g. **baṭ l'um** *b'ait liom*. Nasal plosion also occurs frequently in sandhi, e.g. **klu:d ɴa: k'a:rɴə** *clúid ná cearna*, **kab mo:r** *cab mór*.

[1] *d* differs from *t* (as *g* from *c*) in having voice. *t* as a compensation has greater force of exhalation, and a more vigorous articulation. Following *s*, *t* would be unaspirated, and would lose its extra force of exhalation. In the same position *d* would be unvoiced. Thus, the essential differences between the two being removed, they become indistinguishable.

112. A plosive when followed by another plosive having the same (or a nearby) point of articulation is not exploded. For example the final plosive consonant of the first word of each of the following pairs is unexploded :

ku:g' k'iɴ'	*cúig cinn*,
kat duf	*cat dubh*,
ʃəuk gorəm	*seabhac gorm*,
sop' b'eg	*sop beag*.

113. When two plosives having very different points of articulation come together, both are exploded independently, e.g. **sop koxin'** *sop cochain*, **kat br'ak** *cat breac*.

114. Table of Consonant Phonemes

	Bilabial	Dental	Alveolar, Palato-alveolar	Alveo-palatal	Palato-velar, Velar	Glottal
Plosive	**b' b** **p' p**	**d** **t**	**ḍ** **ṭ**		**g' g** **k' k**	
Fricative	**v' w** **f' f**		**s ʃ**		**j ɣ** **ç x**	**h**
Affricate				**d'** **t'**		
Nasal	**m' m**	**ɴ**	**n n'**	**ɴ'**	**ŋ' ŋ**	
Lateral		**ʟ**	**l l'**	**ʟ'**		
Vibrant			**r r'**			

The terms across the top indicate the organs by which the consonants are articulated, those down the side the manner of articulation.

Plosive Consonants

115. The plosive consonant phonemes of Erris Irish are / **b′ p′**, **b p**, **d t**, **ḍ ṭ**, **g′ k′**, **g k** /.

/ b′ /

116. **b′** denotes a voiced bilabial plosive consonant. The lips are drawn inwards to the teeth. There is simultaneous raising of the front of the tongue towards the hard palate. **b′** occurs in all positions, initially, medially, and finally in words.

Examples—**b′e:l** *béal*, **b′aləx** *bealach*, **b′e:d′ir′** *b′éidir*, **b′o:** *beó*, **br′i:d′** *Brighid*, **br′i:** *bríogh*, **ab′e:l′** *aibéil*, **ka:b′i:n′** *cáibín*, **ebr′u:** *oibriughadh*, **f′el′ib′i:n′** *filbín*, **rib′i:n′** *ribín*, **ker′ib′** *coirb*, **ra:b′** *ráib*, **sguəb′** *sguaib*.

/ p′ /

117. **p′** corresponds to **b′**. It differs in being voiceless, in having greater force of exhalation, and in being aspirated.

Examples—**p′iən** *pian*, **p′ig′i:n′** *pigín*, **p′iʟ′u:** *pilleadh*, **pl′e:sgu:** *pléasgadh*, **p′it′ wog** *pit bhog*, **ap′i:** *abaidh*, **kapt′i:n′** *caiptín*, **k′ip′i:n′** *cipín*, **imp′i:** *impidhe*, **himp′əʟ** *timcheall*.

/ b /

118. **b** represents a voiced bilabial plosive velarized consonant. The lips are slightly protruded and rounded as for **w**. It is unaspirated.

Examples—**ba:d** *bád*, **buka:n** *bacán*, **ba:r** *barr*, **bi:d′əx** *bídeach*, **bli:sg** *blaosg*, **bogləx** *boglach*, **bro:d** *bród*, **bruməx** *bromach*, **bi:** *buidhe*, **klabir′əxd** *clabaireacht*, **kl′ibo:g** *cliobóg*, **kru:bo:g** *crúbóg*, **tumbə** *tomba*, **tuba:n** *tubán*, **borəb** *borb*, **kab** *cab*.

/ p /

119. **p** is articulated as **b**. It differs from **b** in being unvoiced and aspirated.

Examples — **pa:rdu:n** *pardún*, **pa:rʟu:s** *parlús*, **pi:ba:n** *píobán*, **pi:pə** *píopa*, **pla′ʃi:bi:xd** *plaisíobaigheacht*, **pla:ma:s** *plámás*, **puɴta:n** *ponntán*, **puɴtə** *ponta*, **po:r** *pór*, **pra:ɴtəx** *prántach*,

pu:na:lt′ə *púnáilte*, **sgapu:** *sgapadh*, **sdupo:gi:** *stupóga*, **tapi:** *tapaidh*, **krap** *cnap*, **korp** *corp*.

/ d /

120. **d** represents a voiced dental plosive consonant. The tip and blade of the tongue are pressed against the upper front teeth. The contact is usually interdental, that is the tongue touches the lower teeth also.

Examples—**dadi:/tadi:** *dadamh*, **da:r′** *dáir*, **dum** *damh*, **dorəxədəs/dorəxdəs** *dorchadas*, **du:ʟa:nəx** *dubhshlánach*, **bodəx** *bodach*, **ka:rdə** *cárda*, **klu:dəx** *clúdach*, **kuɴdəs** *cundas*, **ugəd** *agat/chugad*, **asəd** *asat*, **bro:d** *bród*, **b′e:l ə wīr′həd** *Béal an Mhuirthead*.

/ t /

121. **t** is the unvoiced aspirated dental plosive corresponding to **d**.

Examples—**tã:w** *támh*, **ə tun/tən** *an tan*, **tarə** *tara*, **trahər** *tarathar*, **tasda:l′** *teastáil*, **to:no:g** *tónóg*, **tiʃd′u:n** *tuistiún*, **tu:rɴ′ə** *túirne*, **trup** *trup*, **tig′ə** *cad chuige*, **kartəxi:** *cartacha*, **ən koʟətə** *chun codlata*, **xuərti:** *chuartaigh*, **atəru:** *eatorra*, **ma:rtən** *Mártan*, **mu:to:g** *mútóg*, **sgatə** *sgata*, **aʟt** *alt*.

/ ḍ /

122. **ḍ** represents an unaspirated voiced alveolar plosive. The tip of the tongue makes contact with the teeth-ridge. It is only faintly palatalized, yet it is felt by speakers to belong to the palatalized class. It is similar to Southern English **d** in ' dig '. It occurs in a limited number of words borrowed from English, in assimilation, and in sandhi positions (§§ 221 sqq.).

Examples—**ḍag′e:r** *daigéar*, **ə ḍa:ra:l′ ə çe:l′i:** *ag dáráil a chéile*, **ḍif′ər** *difear*, **ə jaḍi:** *a dheaidí*, **əḍ′ʃəu** *annseo*, **əḍ′ʃin′** *annsin*, **v′e:rhəḍ ʃe:** *bhéaradh sé*, **ə xiḍ ʃo** *an chuid seo*, **əɴ orəḍ ʃo** *an uiread seo*, **əs m′ihiḍ l′um** *is mithid liom*, **ə troḍ l′um** *ag troid liom*, **k′aʃḍ** *ceaist*, **n′eḍ** *Ned*, **sʟat v′enḍ** *slat bhend*, **ja:rḍ** *yard*.

/ ṭ /

123. **ṭ** is articulated as **ḍ**. It differs from **ḍ** in being unvoiced and aspirated. It is essentially the same as Southern English

t in 'tip'. It occurs in a small number of words borrowed from English, in assimilation, and in sandhi positions.

Examples — **ṭe:** *té*, **ṭiŋk'e:ri:** *tincéir*, **ṭurn** *turn*, **anṭ** *aint*, **er' çanṭ** *ar cheaint*, **gluṭ** *glut* < *gullet*, **k'erṭl'i:n'** *ceirtlín*, **du:rṭ ʃe:** *dubhairt sé*, **xarṭ ʃe:** *chart sé*, **ə ho:rṭ l'um** *a thabhairt liom*.

124. In sandhi positions before **s** (< *a fhios*), when the 3rd p. sg. of a secondary tense of the substantive verb precedes, a non-palatalized alveolar **ṭ** (or **ḍ**) is heard, e.g. **v'eṭs ek'i:** *bheith a fhios aice*.

[d', t']

125. It is convenient to refer here to the plosive allophones of the affricate phonemes /**d'**, **t'**/. For the affricate phonemes see §§ 157 sqq. below. **d'** represents here a voiced unaspirated alveo-palatal plosive. The front of the tongue is raised to make contact with the junction of the teeth-ridge and the hard palate, while the tip of the tongue is down against the lower front teeth. **t'** differs from **d'** in that it is unvoiced.

126. Plosive **d'** replaces affricate **d'** following **ʃ**. When it occurs in utterance final position it is unvoiced.

Examples—**ʃd'u:ru:** *stiúrughadh*, **baʃd'u:** *baisteadh*, **e:ʃd'əxd** *éisteacht*, **ma:ʃd'ir'** *maighistir*, **k'eʃd'** *ceist*.

127. In sandhi plosive **d'** and **t'** regularly replace the corresponding affricates **d'** and **t'** respectively, preceding homorganic affricates, laterals, and nasals. For example in **ə bant' d'il'iʃg'** *ag baint duilisg* the **t'** of **bant'** is an unexploded plosive while the **d'** of **d'il'iʃg'** is an affricate. Similarly in **ə xid' d'el'ign'i:** *a chuid deilgní* the **d'** of **kid'** is an unexploded plosive and the **d'** in **d'el'ign'i:** is an affricate.

/ g' /

128. **g'** denotes a voiced unaspirated palato-velar plosive. The front of the tongue is raised to make contact with the junction of the hard and soft palates, while the tip remains down.

Examples —**g'e:** *géadh*, **g'e:ra:n** *géarán*, **g'u:ro:g** *giughróg*, **gl'o:** *gleó*, **gl'umək** *gliomach*, **əg' im'əxd** *ag imtheacht*, **o:g'ar** *óig-fhear*, **e:g'e:ʟ'i:** *éigcéillidhe*, **kir'ig'i:** *cuiridh*, **b'i:g'i:** *bídh*, **ʟ'ig'i:** *léigidh*, **hig'u:** *thigeadh*, **ar'ig'əd** *airgead*, **ho:g'** *thóg*, **ra:g'** *ráig*, **ʃel'ig'** *seilg*, **ə'l'ig'** *uile* (*go léir*).

/ k' /

129. **k'** is formed as **g'** but is voiceless and aspirated.

Examples — **ən' k'e:** *an té*, **k'e:d** *céad*, **k'e:m'** *céim*, **k'in'u:** *cineadh*, **k'i:x** *cíoch*, **k'o:** *ceó*, **kl'u:** *clú*, **kl'amir'ə** *cleamaire*, **kr'e:tu:r** *créatúr*, **ak'ərə** *aithghiorra*, **m'er'ik'a:** *Meiriceá*, **ba:k'e:ri:** *báicéir*, **b'e:ʟ'ik'o:r'** *béil-léigtheóir*, **pu:k'i:n'** *púicín*, **gro:k'ər** *gróigthear*, **du:l'ik'i:n'**/**du:ʟ'ik'i:n'** *dúilicín*, **aʟuək'əx** *alluaiceach*, **han'ik'** *tháinig/chonnaic*, **b'e:k'** *béic*, **karik'** *carraig*, **pa:rik'** *Pádraig*, **nə hasbik'** *na heasbuig*.

/ g /

130. **g** represents a voiced unaspirated velar plosive. The back of the tongue is pressed against the back part of the soft palate.

Examples—**gra:** *grádh*, **gamb'i:n'** *gaimbín*, **ə gol'** *ag gabháil* (= *dol*), **əg agni:xd** *ag eagnaidheacht*, **gro:ga:n** *grógán*, **su:ga:n** *súgán*, **gə he:go:rəx** *go héagcórach*, **boləgo:g** *bolgóg*, **br'e:gnu:** *bréagnughadh*, **to:ga:l'** *tógbháil*, **uga:n** *eagán*, **ʃi:ga:n** *síogán*, **t'agəs** *teagasg*, **aso:g** *easóg*, **kiɴ'o:g** *cuinneóg*.

/ k /

131. **k** has the same articulation as **g** except that it is voiceless and aspirated.

Examples—**kin'e:l** *cainéal*, **kari:** *cairrfhiadh*, **klu:dəx** *clúdach*, **ko:rhə** *cófra*, **koki:ʃ** *caoicdhighis*, **krãg'i:n'** *cnaigín*, **koləm** *colam*, **krosəx** *crosach*, **ku:la:n** *cúlán*, **bakəx** *bacach*, **bi:ka:n** *buidheacán*, **g'aləka:n** *gealacán*, **f'e:l'əka:n** *féileacán*, **ʃarəki:** *seargtha*, **fa:kər** *fágthar*, **pu:k asil'** *púca asail*, **i:çə noʟək** *Oidhche Nodlag*.

Fricative Consonants

132. The fricative consonant phonemes of the dialect are /**v' f'**, **w f**, **ʃ s**, **j ç**, **ɣ x**, **h**/.

/ v' /

133. **v'** is a palatalized voiced bilabial fricative. The lips are drawn back on to the teeth as in the case of **b'**, but leaving a

narrow passage. A subsidiary nasalized member of this phoneme occurs adjacent to a nasalized vowel.

Examples—**ʃe: v'ī:l'ə** *sé mhíle*, **ə v'īk'** *a mhic*, **ɣa: vl'iən'** *dhá bhliadhain*, **fi: vr'i: mə v'unə** *faoi bhríogh mo mhionna*, **ãvr'əs** *ainhireas*, **an'iv'əs** *ainbhfios*, **sevr'əs** *saidhbhreas*, **kīvn'ə** *cuimhne*, **devl'a:n** *Doivleán*, **i:v'in'** *aoibhinn*, **klãv'ə** *claidheamh*, **g'īvr'u:** *geimhreadh*, **giv'ə** *guidhe*, **rīv'ə** *roimhe*, **iv'əxi:** *uibheacha*, **fevl'e:ri:** *foibhléaraí*, **ʃevn'e:ri:** *siúinéir*, **n'iv'** *neimh*, **ənə lã:v'** *i n-a láimh*, **ariv'** *a fhearaibh* (voc.).

/ f' /

134. **f'** is similar to **v'** in formation except that it is voiceless. A nasalized member of the phoneme occurs adjoining a nasalized vowel.

Examples—**f'ida:n** *feadán*, **f'arəg** *fearg*, **f'i:d'o:g** *fídeóg*, **f'i:do:r'** *figheadóir*, **f'i:gəx** *fíogach*, **f'u:** *fiú*, **f'o:lim'** *foghlaim*, **fr'asdəl** *freastal*, **f'e:n'** *féin* (in verse only, usually **he:n'**), **afr'ən** *aifreann*, **ifr'ən** *ifreann*, **l'efl'iən'** *leith-bhliadhain*, **t'if'i:** *tighthe*, **sop luf'ərni:** *sop luibhthearnaighe*, **kuən ən o:d dif'** *Cuan an Fhód Duibh*.

/ w /

135. **w** represents a voiced bilabial. Adjoining a nasalized vowel a nasalized **w** occurs. Three varieties of **w** can be distinguished according to position. Initially before a vowel **w** is a velarized lip-rounded semi-vowel, e.g. **wuləx** *ualach*, **wum** *uaim*, **wufə** *uatha*, **wog l'eʃ** *bhog leis*, **wan'** *bhain*, **wiŋ'** *mhuing*, **slat wãrə** *slat mhara*, **er' wuəlin'** *ar ghualainn*, **ə fa:l' wa:ʃ** *ag fagháil bháis*.

136. In intervocalic position in word or phrase **w** is weakly fricative ; in terminal position the friction is more perceptible.

Examples—**g'e:wi:** *géadha*, **kl'iəwa:n** *cliabhán*, **d'i:wa:l'** *díogh-bháil*, **marəwa:nəx** *marbhánach*, **sna:wo:r'** *snámhóir*, **ə l'e:w afr'in'** *ag léaghadh aifrinn*, **lã:w ə'wa:n'** *lámh amháin*, **sna:w** *snámh*, **l'a:w** *leaghadh*, **ga:w** *gábhadh*, **dl'i:w** *dligheadh*, **'ba:rhra:w** *Barrthrágha*.

137. The most strongly fricative variety of **w** occurs preceding **l**, **r**, e.g. **fi: wla:** *faoi bhláth*, **wləi ʃe:** *ghlaodh sé*, **ə wro:** *an bhró*.

/ f /

138. **f** is a velarized voiceless bilabial fricative. The lips are slightly protruded and rounded as for **w**. A nasalized member of the phoneme occurs adjacent to a nasalized vowel.

Examples—**fuə ʃe:** *chuaidh sé*, **'fari:r** *fa-rior*, **fəihəx** *foightheach*, **'afuər'** *athuair*, **ka:fri:** *cáthbhruiih*, **kã:fəl** *camall*, **ʃrufa:n** *sruthán*, **lofi:** *lobhtha*, **xrufi:** *chruthaigh*, **lu:fər** *lúthmhar*, **l'ī:fi:** *líomhtha*, **l'o:fə** *leó*, **ə'n'uf** *aniogh*, **bruf** *bruth*, **duf** *dubh*, **v'i:f** *bhíodh*, **uf** *ogh*, **t'uf** *tiugh*, **gadi:f** *gadaigheadha*, **d'e:lo:f** *d'éalóghadh*.

/ ʃ /

139. There are two very distinct members of the /ʃ/phoneme. The principal member is a voiceless palato-alveolar fricative, in the formation of which the blade of the tongue is raised towards the teeth-ridge, the front towards the hard palate, and the tip is placed behind the lower front teeth.

Examples—**ʃagəl** *seagal*, **ʃer'** *soir*, **ə ʃa:nt'** *ag taisbeáint*, **ʃe:su:r** *séasúr*, **ʃiʃe:l** *siséal*, **i:l' ʃin' ʃa:n'** *Oidhche fhéil Sain Seáin*, **ʃg'itər iʃg'ə** *sgiotar uisge*, **heʃi:** *thoisigh*, **eʃi:n'** *Oisín/oisín*, **fa:ʃg'i:n'** *fáisgín*, **iʃg'ə kaʃg'** *uisge coisreacdha*, **kuəʃi:n'** *cuaisín*, **dr'iʃu:r** *drisiúr*, **dr'iʃ** *dris*, **bahiʃ** *baithis*, **d'i:l'iʃ** *dílis*, **ən' t'a:ʃ** *an t-áis*, **bo: wõxiʃ**, *bó mhochais*.

140. Adjoining **r** a velarized post-alveolar variety of **ʃ** is used. In the formation of this the blade of the tongue is slightly curled back with lateral contraction behind the teeth-ridge. The homorganic **r** adjoining it is also somewhat inverted. This **ʃr** is the acoustic equivalent of *shr* in English 'shred', 'shrug'. In Erris generally this homorganic post-alveolar articulation of **ʃr** and **rʃ** prevails. There are, however, good speakers, in Faulmore at least, who use **sr** and not **ʃr** in words such as *sruth*, *sraith*.

Examples—**ʃra:d'** *sráid*, **ʃriən** *srian*, **ʃraç** *sraith*, **ʃram** *sream*, **ə ʃro:fərti:** *ag sreódhfartaigh*, **a:rʃə** *áirse*, **ka:rʃa:n** *carsán*, **ku:rʃə** *cúrsa*, **kõ:rʃə** *comharsa*, **k'e:rʃəx** *céirseach*, **farʃin'** *fairsing*, **p'e:rʃo:g** *péirseóg*. Post-alveolar articulation of **rʃ** occurs regularly also in sandhi, e.g. **er ʃən f'ar ʃo** *ars an fear seo*.

/ s /

141. **s** is a voiceless alveolar fricative. The blade of the tongue is raised towards the teeth-ridge, while the tip touches the lower teeth. Velarization is not very marked, the degree being affected by adjoining sounds.

Examples—**sosdəx** *sostach*, **sip'e:r** *suipéar*, **du:səxd** *dúsacht*, **trosgu:** *trosgadh*, **i:si:** *íosaidh*, **a:rəs** *árus*, **ba:s** *bás*.

142. An allophone of **s** formed by the blade of the tongue being raised towards the upper front teeth occurs before dental **d**, **t**, **n**, **l**. Preceding **n** and **l** particularly the acoustic difference between this and the first member is striking.

Examples—**sla:n** *slán*, **slat** *slat*, **sna:** *snáth*, **k'e:slə** *céasla*, **osnə** *osna*.

/ j /

143. The principal member of the /**j**/phoneme is a palatal semi-vowel. This occurs initially before vowels (other than **i:**) and medially between vowels. The tongue takes up approximately the position appropriate for the vowel **i:** (§ 31) and moves immediately to the position of the following vowel.

Examples—**ən' je:** *an ghéadh*, **ə je:d** *a dhéad*, **ju:n** *dheamhan*, **fi: jasi:** *faoi gheasaibh*, **t'in'ə jula:n'** *teine ghealáin*, **bə je:** *budh é*, **do:ju:l'** *dóigheamhail*, **yrõ:jə ʃe:** *ghnóaigh sé*, **in'iʃ g'e:jə** *Inis Géidhe*.

144. A subsidiary member with very slight friction occurs initially before **i:**, e.g. **ə ji:ma:nəx** *a ghíománach*, **gə ji:l'əxdi:** *de dhílleachtaí*.

145. Preceding **r'**, **l'**, a third member is used which has clearly audible friction. This is more retracted than the second member. Indeed in a narrow transcription one might well employ the symbol **γ'** for this third member of /**j**/, as it corresponds to plosive **g'** in tongue position with the difference, however, that with this there is narrowing, with **g'** closure.

Examples of this strongly fricative and somewhat retracted **j** occur initially, e.g. **ən' jr'iən** *an ghrian*, **ya: jr'im'** *dhá ghreim*, and in compounds, e.g. **m'i:jr'an** *mi-ghreann*.

146. In final position following a vowel or diphthong **j** is frictionless and gives the impression of a shortened variety of the vowel **i:** described in § 31.

Examples—**b'ej** *beidh*, **re:j** *réidh*, **tra:j** *tráigh*, **maro:j** *maróidh*, **kruəj** *cruaidh*, **fuəj** *chuaidh*.

/ ç /

147. **ç** denotes a voiceless palato-velar fricative. Preceding **l'**, **r'**, its point of articulation is that of **j** in such position. When it precedes a vowel, the tongue position is more forward. Friction is clearly audible in all positions.

Examples—**ça:n'** *thaisbéin*, **çu:l'** *shiobhail*, **ço:lhin'** *sheólfainn*, **mə çin'u:** *mo chineadh*, **ba:çu e:** *báitheadh é*, **ra:çə** *ráithe*, **f'içə** *fiche*, **içə** *ithe*, **dr'iça:r'** *dearbh-bhráthair*, **için'** *inchinn*, **l'e:çə** *lé*, **im'içə** *imthighthe*, **k'içə** *cioth*, **sa:çə tu:** *sáithfidh tú*, **ʃraç** *sraith*, **uəç** *uaigh*, **ə'miç/ə'muç** *amuigh*, **ə'ʃd'iç** *istigh*, **a:ç ə wraç** *áith an bhraich*, **ə riç** *ag rith*, **mə ha:ç** *mo sháith*, **treç** *troigh*, **er' ə gruəç** *ar an gcruaich*, **sgaç ən' e:di:** *sgoith an éadaigh*, **ʃl'eç** *sleigh*.

/ γ /

148. **γ** is a voiced velar fricative formed by raising the back of the tongue towards the back part of the soft palate, while the tip of the tongue lies low.

149. **γ** in general occurs only initially in words, e.g. **γo:** *dhó*, **γi:m** *dhíom*, **γa:re:g** *dhá-fhear-dhéag*, **ə γra:** *a ghrádh*, **klox γlas** *cloch ghlas*, **mər γuəl** *mar ghual*, **er' γroxhalu:** *ar dhroch-thalamh*, **xil'ə γo:nəx** *gach uile Dhomhnach*.

Occasionally **γ** occurs medially in a compound such as **ta:rγad** *tarr-ghad*.

/ x /

150. **x** is articulated in the same manner as **γ** but is voiceless. It occurs initially, medially, and finally in words.

Examples—**ə xolu:** *do chodladh*, **fi: xa:ʃg'** *faoi Cháisg*, **ə'xi:çə** *choidhche*, **ya: xart'** *dhá chairt*, **ba:r ə xladi:** *barr an chladaigh*, **ya: xoʃ** *dhá chois*, **baxlo:g** *bachlóg*, **koxəl** *cochall*, **grõ:xən** *gnóachan*, **lo:xa:n** *lóchán*, **n'i:xa:n** *nigheachán*, **gə bra:x** *go bráth*, **sa:x** *sáthach*, **gə fo:l'əx** beside **gə fo:l'** *go fóill*, **bla:x** *bláthach*, **bro:x** *brodhach*.

/ h /

151. **h** is a voiceless fricative. Any friction there is occurs in the glottis as the air passes between the open vocal chords. **h** is unique among the consonants of the dialect in that it has not got the two qualities, palatal and velar, as the other consonants have.

152. **h** occurs initially before all vowels, e.g. **hart** *thart*, **he:n'** *féin*, **her'** *thoir*, **hanə** *cheana*, **himp'əʟ** *timcheall*, **hu:ru:** *adubhradh*, **hugəd ə'ʃd'ax** *chugad isteach*, **ɴ'i: hu:rhiɴ'** *ní thiobhrainn*, **humpəʃe:** *d'iompaigh sé*, **hinʃi:f** *hinnsíodh*, **klox hu:ga:n'** *cloch shúgáin*, **ho:bər ɴa:r wa: ʃi: e:** *fhóbair nár bháith sí é*.

153. Medially in intervocalic position **h** occurs following **a:**, **o:**, **uə**, **i:**, **iə**, **e:**, **a**, **o**, **e**, e.g. **ba:hu:** *báthadh*, **bo:hər** *bóthar*, **buk'e:d ʟuəhu:** *buicéad luatha*, **v'i:hi:** *bhíthí*, **ʟ'iəhi:ɴ** *liathaigheann*, **ʃe:hu:** *séanhadh*, **sgahu:** *sgathamh*, **boha:n** *bothán*, **b'ehi:** *beathadhaigh*, **a: m'eha:** *dá mbeitheá*. Following **u** intervocalic **h**, if it occurs at all, is rare; no example of it has been observed. Following **i** it is not common; **əs m'ihəd dum** *is mithid damh* is one example.

154. A rather weak **h** occurs in final position following the short vowels **e**, **a**, **o** only, e.g. **br'eh** *breith*, **ʟ'ah** *leath*, **ə sgoh** *a sgothadh*. **h** does not occur finally following a long vowel or diphthong ; neither does it occur finally following **i**, **u**. Following **i** or **u** there is friction elsewhere, i.e. palatal friction in the case of **i**, bilabial friction in the case of **u**. That is to say that following **i** and **u**, **h** is replaced by **ç** and **f** respectively, e.g. **b'iç** *bith*, **ʃruf** *sruth*.

155. Initially and medially **h** may precede **n**, **n'**, **l**, **l'**, **r**, **r'**, which it has the effect of devoicing, e.g. **kr'ahnəx** *creathnach*, **dahn'i:** *d'aithnigh*, **ahla:n** *athlán*, **ka:hl'a:n** *cáithleán*, **k'ahru:** *ccathramhadh*, **ahr'iʃ** *aithris*.

156. Medially **h** occurs following **n**, **n'**, **l**, **l'**, **r**, **r'**, which it partially devoices, e.g. **tanhi:** *tanaidhe*, **wan'hi:** *bhainfidhe*, **o:lhi:** *ólfaidh*, **hi:l'ha:** *shaoilfeá*, **m'e:rho:g** *méaróg*.

Affricate Consonants

/ d', t' /

157. These Erris affricates are not very different from English

dʒ, **tʃ** in **dʒig** ' jig ' and **tʃiə** ' cheer ' respectively. There does seem however to be a difference, which is this: for **tʃ** as in English ' cheer ' the tip of the tongue is up, and there is also some protrusion of the lips. For **tʃ**[1] as in Erris Irish **tʃitʃ** *tuit*, **tʃax** *teach*, the tip of the tongue is down against the lower teeth and the lips are spread. For the Erris Irish affricates, then, it may be said that the primary articulation is palatal, the secondary alveolar. The front of the tongue is raised to make a closure at the junction of the teeth-ridge and hard palate, and is then slowly released, causing friction in a narrowing between tongue and teeth-ridge, while the tip of the tongue remains against the lower front teeth.

158. Affricate **d'** differs from affricate **t'** in that it is voiced. This voiced affricate occurs in the following examples: **d'arəməd** *dearmad*, **d'aso:g** *deasóg*, **d'er'u:** *deireadh*, **d'ox** *deoch*, **d'umu:** *diomdha*, **ed'əs** *oideas*, **pad'ir'** *paidir*, **ʃe:d'u:** *séideadh*, **gar'id'** *gairid*, **d'iəʟid'** *diallaid*, **a:rd'** *aird*.

159. Examples of affricate **t'** occur in **t'as** *teas*, **t'iɴ'əs** *teinneas*, **t'ig'əɴ** *tuigeann*, **et'iɴ'** *eitinn*, **kl'et'ə** *cleite*, **kr'et'a:l** *cniteál*, **ə ra:t'/ə ra:** *ag rádh*, **tarint'** *tarraing*, **plat'** *plait*, **fo:nt'** *foghaint*, **fel'u:nt'** *oireamhain*.

160. For affricate **d'** replaced by a plosive allophone following **ʃ** see § 126, where examples are given.

Nasal Consonants

161. Nasal consonants are formed by closure of the mouth passage at some point with simultaneous lowering of the velum so that air can pass out through the nose passage. The nasal consonant phonemes of Erris Irish are /**m'**, **m**, **ɴ**, **n**, **n'**, **ɴ'**, **ŋ'**, **ŋ**/.

/ m' /

162. **m'** denotes a palatalized voiced bilabial nasal. The lips are drawn in somewhat on the teeth as for **b'**, **p'**.

Examples—**m'ax** *beach*, **m'e:d'** *méid*, **m'i:n'** *mín*, **m'i:l** *míol*,

[1] Throughout this book the special phonetic symbols **dʒ**, **tʃ** have been dispensed with, and replaced by **d'**, **t'**, respectively, as more convenient.

sm'e:r *sméar*, **im'əxd** *imtheacht*, **k'i'm'e:d'** *coimhéid*, **ʃɪn'im'** *seinm*, **t'it'im'** *tuitim*.

/ m /

163. **m** denotes a velarized voiced bilabial nasal. The lips are slightly protruded as for **b**, **p**.

Examples—**ma:m** *mám*, **mi:r** *maor*, **maru:** *marbh*, **mu:ʃi:m** *móisiam*, **me:ʃd'əxd** *m'éisteacht*, **mint'ɪn'** *m'intinn*, **ə t'arəmən** *An Tearmann*, **amsgi:** *amsgaoidhe*, **blogəm** *bolgam*, **g'amxi:x** *geam-chaoch*, **am** *am*, **tum** *tom*.

/ ɴ /

164. **ɴ** denotes a voiced dental nasal consonant formed by placing the tip and blade of the tongue against the upper front teeth as for **d** and **t**.

Examples—**əɴ arig'ə** *an fhairrge*, **əɴ iʃo:g** *an fhuiseóg*, **ɴi:w** *naomh*, **i:ɴtəs** *iongantas*, **ə'ɴa:l** *anall*, **aɴu:** *annamh*, **k'e:ɴə** *céadna*, **gra:ɴə** *gránna*, **m'iɴa:n** *meannán*, **ruɴəx** *ronnach*, **ʃaɴin'ə** *seanduine*, **k'aɴ** *ceann*, **klaɴ** *clann*, **krak'əɴ** *craiceann*, **f'iɴ** *fionn*, **gaɴ** *gann*, **g'e:v'əɴ** *géibheann*, **raɴ** *rann*, **t'aɴ** *teann*, **toɾəɴ** *torann*.

165. Non-palatal *n* preceded by **s** or by **r** is always a dental, and, moreover, the preceding **s** or **r** has always clearly perceptible dental articulation, that is to say that the friction causing **s** in this case is between blade and upper front teeth, and in the case of **r** the vibration is against the upper front teeth.

Examples — **sna:** *snáth*, **sna:w** *snámh*, **osnə** *osna*, **trasni:** *tarsna*, **darnə** *darna*, **ka:ɾnu:** *carnadh*, **o:ɾnə** *eórna*, **oɾni:** *urnaighthe*.

/ n /

166. **n** represents a velarized voiced alveolar or post-alveolar nasal consonant. The tip of the tongue makes contact with the teeth-ridge at a point farther back than in the case of **n'**.

Examples—**l'e: no:l** *lé n-ól*, **l'e: nanəm** *lé n-a anam*, **xil'ə nolik'** *gach uile Nodlaig*, **anro:** *annró*, **baniʃ** *banais*, **banri:n** *bainríoghan*, **l'e: fa:ni:** *lé fánaidh*, **hanə** *cheana*, **l'ãwnəxd** *leamhnacht*, **b'an ɣlu:n** *bean ghlún*, **bri:n** *braon*, **bro:n** *brón*, **k'un** *cion*, **kuən** *cuan*, **pula:n** *pollán*, **er' mə hun** *ar mo shon*, **ba:r ən ri:** *barr an fhraoigh*.

167. When **h** precedes, it has the effect of devoicing the **n**.

This devoiced **n** is common in medial position in words. Only in cases of lenition is it heard initially.

Examples—**br'ahnəx** *Breatnach*, **br'ahni:** *breathnaigh*, **çr'uhni:** *chriothnaigh*, **trə'hno:ni:** *tráth nóna*.

/ n' /

168. **n'** denotes a palatalized voiced alveolar nasal consonant formed by raising the tip of the tongue to make contact with the teeth-ridge.

Examples—**l'e: n'iç** *lé n-ithe*, **l'e: n'im'əxd** *lé n-imtheacht*, **mə n'art** *mo neart*, **fi: n'asexd/n'isexd** *faoi neasacht*, **asgin'i:** *easgainighe*, **k'in'u:** *cineadh*, **d'el'ign'əx** *deilgneach*, **e:n'i:n'** *éinín*, **fan'ik'** *fainic*, **ə g'e:mn'əx** *ag géimneach*, **ə l'e:mn'əx** *ag léimneach*, **l'e:n'i:** *léine*, **ən'ʃin'** *annsin*, **k'an' ʃi:n'ə** *Ceann Sine*, **krakn'i:** *craicne*, **imn'i:** *imneadh*, **la:nu:n'** *lánamhain*, **m'o:n'** *meadhóin*, **ʃi:xa:n'** *síothcháin*.

169. **n'** regularly occurs before **ʃ**, e.g. **ən' ʃi:l** *an síol* ; and before the affricates **d'** and **t'** at the end of a syllable, e.g. **kant'** *cainnt*, **du:nt'i:** *dúinte*.

170. Where **h** precedes **n'** the result is an unvoiced **n'**. This occurs medially. Initially it is found only in cases of grammatical lenition.

Examples—**krihn'əxd** *cruithneacht*, **d'ihn'u:r** *deichneabhar*, **fahn'ə** *faithne*, **flihn'axdə** *flich-shneachta*, **l'ihn'əxd** *leithneacht*, **mihn'e:l/min'e:l/miçe:l** *muinéal*, **rahn'əx** *raithneach*, **tahn'u:x** *taitneamhach*, **tra:hn'i:n'** *tráithnín*.

/ ɴ' /

171. **ɴ'** denotes a voiced alveo-palatal nasal consonant. The front of the tongue makes contact with the hard palate causing stoppage in the mouth passage while the velum is lowered. The tip of the tongue is down against the lower front teeth.

Examples—**ɴ'art** *neart*, **ɴ'anto:g** *neanntóg*, **ɴ'iv'** *neimh*, **ɴ'i:xa:n** *nigheachán*, **ɴ'i: ɣlakiɴ'** *ní ghlacfainn*, **ə'ɴ'e:** *ané*, **ə'ɴ'uf** *aniogh*, **ə'ɴ'as** *andeas*, **ə'ɴ'er'** *anoir*, **ə'ɴ'iər** *aniar*, **əɴ' e:ɴtərəs/e:ɴtrəs** *i n-aon-turus*, **t'ax əɴ' ir'** *teach an fhir*, **er' əɴ' il'a:n** *ar an oiléan*, **əɴ' o:ɾnə** *an eórna*, **fi:ɴ' l'ak** *faoi'n leac*, **əɴ' t'ax** *an teach*, **baɴ'ə** *bainne*, **biɴ'u:** *buinneadh*, **m'i:ɴ'l'əx** *mínleach*, **t'iɴ'əs klaɴ'ə**

teinneas clainne, **ʃʟ'ɪɴ'a:n** *slinnéan,* **re:ʟtə nə maɴ'ə** *réalta na maidne,* **d'ɪɴ'ɪʃ** *d'innis,* **a: hɪɴ'o:n'** *dá haindeóin,* **aɴ'ɪr'** *ainnir,* **sba:ɴ'əx** *Spáinneach,* **ahɪɴ'ə** *aithinne,* **fa:ɴ'ə kumɪɴ'** *fáinne cumainn,* **sʟaɴ'u:** *sloinneadh,* **p'i:ɴ'** *peinginn,* **rɪɴ'** *roinn,* **v'ehɪɴ'** *bheinn,* **harɪɴ'** *tharainn,* **b'ɪɴ'** *beinn.*

172. **ɴ'** regularly follows **r**, **ʃ**, and sometimes **v'**, in words, e.g. **ba:rɴ'əx** *bairneach,* **ta:rɴ'ə** *tairnge,* **fa:rɴ'ɪʃ** *fáirnis,* **ma:rɴ'e:ləx** *mairnéalach,* **ʃɴ'i:w** *sníomh,* **ʃɴ'a:** *sneadh,* **m'ɪʃɴ'əx** *meisneach,* **ʃevɴ'e:ri:** *siúinéir,* **sɪvɴ'əx** *Suibhneach,* **er' ɣãvɴ'əxd** *ar dhoimhneacht,* **gevɴ'i:** *goibhne,* **ə ʟa:r nə hevɴ'ə** *i lár na haibhne.*

/ ŋ' /

173. **ŋ'** is a voiced palato-velar nasal consonant corresponding to **g'** in articulation ; for the closure the tongue makes contact at the junction of the hard and soft palates. The velum is lowered.

Examples—**er' ə ŋ'aləx** *ar an ngealach,* **sə ŋ'ɪvr'u:** *sa ngeimhreadh,* **ə ŋ'e:v'ən** *i ngéibheann,* **aŋ'əl** *aingeal,* **ɪŋn'i:** *ingne,* **kɪŋk' də wiçi:l'** *coingc do mhuinéil,* **wɪŋ'** *mhuing,* **ə ʟɪŋ'** *i luing.*

/ ŋ /

174. **ŋ** represents a voiced velar nasal consonant corresponding to **g**. The back of the tongue makes contact with the back of the soft palate.

Examples—**ə ŋa:ri:** *i ngarrdha,* **sə ŋort** *sa ngort,* **ə ŋunəsd** *i ngan-fhios,* **ri: nə ŋra:sdə** *Rí na ngrásta,* **k'aŋəl** *ceangal,* **aŋk** *amharc,* **ʃuŋa:n** *seangán,* **aŋəx** *eangach,* **dr'aŋkid'i:** *deargnaite,* **uŋə** *ionga,* **maŋəx** *mangach,* **t'aŋi:** *teanga,* **fraŋkəx** *frangcach,* **paŋk** *pangc.*

Lateral Consonants

175. In the articulation of all lateral consonants there is blockage of the air stream in the mouth at the centre, with free passage for the air at the side or sides. Laterals may be dental, alveolar, or palatal. All three varieties are represented in Erris. The following lateral phonemes occur in the dialect : /**ʟ**, **l**, **l'**, **ʟ'**/.

/ ʟ /

176. **ʟ** represents a velarized voiced dental lateral consonant. It is formed by pressing the tip and blade of the tongue against the upper front teeth, leaving a passage at both sides of the tongue for the air to pass. Simultaneously, the back of the tongue is raised towards the soft palate, which gives the consonant its rather dark quality. **ʟ** may be interdental.

Examples—**gə ʟuə** *go luath,* **ə ʟuɴdin'** *i Lonndain,* **ʟəir** *ladhar,* **ʟo:həna:n** *lóthannán,* **muʟəx** *mullach,* **toʟu:** *tolladh,* **m'i:ʟto:g** *míoltóg,* **u:ʟə** *ubhall,* **poʟ dasgəʟə** *poll d'asgalla,* **sbaʟi:xd** *spallaigheacht,* **buʟa:n** *bullán,* **iəʟ** *iall,* **bariəʟ** *bairr-iall,* **goʟ** *Goll,* **himp'əʟ** *timcheall,* **i:ʃəʟ** *iseal,* **koxəʟ** *cochall,* **ə ŋ'uʟ er'** *i ngioll ar,* **daʟ** *dall,* **rubəʟ** *earball,* **gaʟ** *Gall,* **kɪɴ'əʟ** *coinneal,* **ta:wəʟ** *tábhall,* **b'ɪʟə/b'uʟə** *biolla.*

177. When non-palatal **s** is immediately followed by **ʟ** in a word, they have both very pronounced dental (or interdental) articulation.

Examples—**sʟa:nt'ə** *sláinte,* **t'asʟu:** *teasladh,* **sʟig'u:** **e:** *sloigeadh é,* **sʟəuk** *slabhac.*

178. Likewise non-palatal **r** and following **ʟ** have both very perceptible dental (or interdental) articulation.

Examples—**b'e:rʟə** *Béarla,* **p'e:rʟə** *péarla,* **ən' t'urʟə** *an t-iolar,* **ka:rʟə** *cárla,* **garʟə** *galar,* **ha:rʟi:** *tharla,* **d'arʟu:** *deallradh.*

/ l /

179. **l** represents a velarized voiced post-alveolar lateral consonant.[1] The tip of the tongue, rather spread, makes contact

[1] I should mention here that at first in Erris I had a real difficulty in hearing the distinction between velar dental **ʟ** and velar alveolar **l** —a distinction I had expected to find in the dialect. The two sounds are rather similar in acoustic effect and my ear was just not keen enough to be able to distinguish them. Gradually the difference became perceptible in such pairs as the following : *capall* v. *asal, ballach* v. *bealach, iall* v. *aol.* I had a similar difficulty with regard to **ɴ** and **n**. Through time, however, I came to be able to distinguish between them in such pairs as *croiceann* v. *cochan, crann* v. *glan, fireann* v. *feadán.* The conclusion I finally reached with regard to the speech of Sb was that his distribution conformed to what is historically justified. Initially he seemed as a rule to use alveolar forms in cases where lenition was required. Speakers of a younger generation seem to be substituting dental for alveolar forms, especially in initial position.

with the teeth-ridge at a point farther back than it does in the articulation of **l'**.

Examples—**lag ə ʟa:** *lag an lá*, **alo:g ʃɴ'axdə** *alóg sneachta*, **baləx** *balach*, **balu:** *balughadh/baladh*, **klox** *cloch*, **kõ:li:** *comhla*, **koli:** *culaidh*, **kaləpi: kos** *calpaí cos*, **dlu:** *dlúth*, **ə waləx** *i bhfalach*, **olə** *ola*, **ə tla:nt'ə** *an tsláinte*, **talu:** *talamh*, **ta:ləx** *tadhlach*, **falsə** *fallsa*, **a:l** *ál*, **ku:l** *cúl*, **b'e:l** *béal*.

180. Following **h**, **l** is devoiced, e.g. **korhləx** *Corrchloch*.

/ l' /

181. **l'** represents a palatalized voiced alveolar lateral consonant. It is formed by pressing the tip of the tongue against the teeth-ridge, leaving a passage at both sides for the air to pass out.

Examples—**l'ig' tu:** *léig tú*, **l'e: m'e:** *léigh mé*, **l'e: mə l'iɴ'** *lé mo linn*, **ɴ'i:r l'ox** *níor fhliuch*, **mə l'e:n** *mo léan!* **də l'e:n'i:** *do léine*, **a: l'e:r ʃin'** *dá réir sin*, **xil'ə** *gach uile*, **kil'o:g** *cuileóg*, **bol'ig'** *boilg*, **f'el'im'** *feirm*, **i:l'əx** *aoileach*, **m'e:l'əx** *meidhleach*, **p'el'u:r** *piliúr*, **'po:'l'i:** *póilí*, **ribl'i:** *ruible*, **sa:l'ə** *sáile*, **kodil'** *codail*, **droxwal'** *droch-bhail*, **ʟa:l' pa:rik'** *Lá fhéil Pádraig*, **f'o:l'** *feóil*, **fil'** *fuil*, **sal'** *sail*, **su:l'** *súil*.

182. When **h** precedes **l'** the result is an unvoiced **l'**. It is of rare occurence in medial position, e.g. **ka:hl'əx** *cáithleach*. Initially **hl'** occurs only as the lenited form of **ʃʟ'**, e.g. **hl'ãwni:** *shleamhnaigh*.

/ ʟ' /

183. **ʟ'** denotes a voiced alveo-palatal lateral consonant. In forming **ʟ'** the front of the tongue makes contact with the hard palate at the centre of the mouth leaving a passage free for the air to pass out at the side or sides. **ʟ'** somewhat suggests **lj** in English **miljən** ' million '. The main difference is that while in English **lj** are easily separable, in Irish they combine and fuse in one articulation. In Irish, too, the tip of the tongue is against the lower front teeth.

Examples—**ʟ'a:mi:** *leaghma*, **ʟ'a b'ali:**, *leath bealaigh*, **ʟ'ahəx** *leathach*, **ʟ'e:m'** *léim*, **ʟ'ehədəx** *leitheadach*, **ʟ'i:hi:** *lighfidh*, **ʟ'i:n** *líon*, **ʟ'o:** *leó*, **gə ʟ'o:r** *go leór*, **bariʟ'ə** *baraille*, **kaʟ'əx** *cailleach*, **fi:ʟ'əx** *fuidhleach*, **g'e:ʟ'u:nt'** *géilleadh*, **iʟ'ə** *uille*, **mla:wəʟ'əx** *Maolfhábhailleach*, **p'iʟ'u:** *pilleadh*, **sbroxiʟ'ə** *sprochaille*, **k'iʟ' alə** *Cill Alaidh*, **asgiʟ'** *asgaill*.

184. **ʟ'** follows **ʃ**, e.g. **kuʃʟ'a:n** *caisléan*, **kaʃʟ'i:n'** *caislín*, **ʃʟ'a:n** *sleaghán*, **ʃʟ'ãwin'** *sleamhain*, **ʃʟ'eç** *sleigh*, **ʃʟ'iəw** *sliabh*, **ʃʟ'oxd** *sliocht*, **uəʃʟ'ə** *uaisle* ; and also **ʀ**, e.g. **kõ:ʀʟ'ə** *comhairle*, **smugəʀʟ'ə** *smugairle*.

Vibrant Consonants

/ ʀ /

185. **ʀ** represents a velarized voiced post-alveolar flapped consonant. The tip of the tongue, rather spread, makes one tap against the back of the teeth-ridge. The back of the tongue is simultaneously raised towards the soft palate.

Examples—**rah** *rath*, **re:su:n** *réasún*, **ri:** *rí*, **ro:t'i:** *reóite*, **ro:n** *rón*, **ros** *ros*, **ə'ma:rəx** *amárach*, **kru:** *crodh*, **krũk** *cnoc*, **krũəsəx** *cnuasach*, **ɣa:re:g** *dhá-fhear-dhéag*, **e:go:rəx** *éagcórach*, **farig'ə** *fairrge*, **f'i:riʃg'ə** *fíor-uisge*, **maru:** *marbh*, **m'asərə** *measardha*, **mrĩ:** *mnaoi*, **orəd** *uiread*, **e:ɴ trã:w** *aon tsnámh*, **ʃarəx** *searrach*, **ʃriən** *srian*, **ʃrahu:** *sreathadh*, **trũ:** *tnúth*, **a:wər** *adhbhar*, **doxdu:r** *doctúir*, **fõ:wər** *foghmhar*.

186. **ʀ** occurs regularly before **ɴ'**, **ʟ'**, **d'**, **t'**, **ʃ**, e.g. **ba:ʀɴ'əx** *bairneach*, **kõ:ʀʟ'ə** *comhairle*, **a:rd'** *aird*, **ku:rt'** *cúirt*, **farʃiɴ'** *fairsing*.

187. **ʀ** has a dental allophone used before **ɴ** and **ʟ**. It consists of a vigorous flap of the blade of the tongue against the teeth-ridge and the inner side of the upper front teeth, merging in a dental (or interdental) **ɴ** or **ʟ**. The acoustic effect is very different from that of ordinary **ʀ**.

Examples—**o:ʀnə** *eórna*, **garʟə** *galar*, **urʟə** *iolar*.

188. **ʀ** is partially devoiced when it occurs before **p**, **t**, **k**, and **ʃ** (§ 107).

Examples—**korp** *corp*, **ort** *ort*, **k'ark** *cearc*, **ka:rʃa:n** *carsán*.

189. When **h** precedes **ʀ** medially, the result is an unvoiced **ʀ**. This also occurs initially in cases of lenition, where it replaces **tr**.

Examples—**ahri:** *athraigh*, **kohrəm** *comhthrom*, **k'o:hra:n**

ceóbhrán, **manhrəx** *bannrach,* **k'anhrəx** *ceannrach,* **malhrid'** *malairt,* **hri:d'** *thríd.* (See § 205).

190. In certain words **r** begins with voice and becomes devoiced towards the end, that is, becomes **rh**. This mostly occurs following a long vowel or diphthong as in the words **si:rhu:** *saothrughadh,* **ta:rha:l'** *tarrtháil,* **tr'e:rhəx** *trćathrach,* **f'iərhi:** *fiafraighc.* In the word *punnann* Sb has voiced **r** :— **purən**, but many of those of a generation later have **rh** : — **purhən**.

/ r' /

191. **r'** denotes a palatalized voiced flapped alveolar consonant formed by one tap of the tip of the tongue against the front part of the teeth-ridge. Palatalized **r'** does not occur in initial position in words in Erris Irish.

Examples—**ə'r'i:ʃd'** *arís,* **ə'r'ĭəw** *a-riamh,* **da: 'r'i:r'i:** *dá ríribh,* **a:r'i:m'** *áirmhim,* **ar'ig'əd** *airgead,* **br'a:n** *biorán,* **br'ak** *breac,* **k'er'ə** *ceithre,* **kr'ogi:** *criogaí,* **d'er'hu:r/d'er'əhu:r** *deirbh-shiúr,* **d'i:r'əx** *díreach,* **e:r'ə** *Éire,* **gr'im'** *greim,* **gr'i:w** *gníomh,* **ləir'ik'i:n'** *laidhricín,* **ger'əsi:** *d'uireasbhaidh,* **padr'i:n'** *paidrín,* **tar'iv'** *tairbh,* **har'iʃ** *thairis,* **t'e:r'i:** *téirigh,* **er' aʃ** *ar ais,* **er' a:bəlt** *ar ábalta.*

192. In final position the one tap is not so clear-cut and the consonant finishes as a fricative with many speakers.[1]

Examples—**ə're:r'** *aréir,* **ahir'** *athair,* **e:t'ir'** *éitir,* **ehir'** *ithir,* **ə la:hir'** *i láthair,* **obir'** *obair,* **fi: re:r'** *faoi réir,* **sev'ir'** *saidhbhir,* **sb'aləde:r'** *spealadóir,* **tr'o:r'** *treóir,* **uər'** *uair.*

193. Preceding **p'** or **k'**, **r'** is partially devoiced (§ 107).

194. Unvoiced **r'** occurs in medial position following **h**. Initially **hr'** is found as the lenited form of **tr'**.

Examples—**ahr'əxi:** *aithreacha,* **a:hr'id'** *áirithe,* **ahr'i:** *aithrighe,* **k'ehr'i:n'** *ceirín.*

[1] So fricative had **r'** become in the speech of PAG of Dû Chaocháin that the symbol **ʃ** might well be employed to record it in such words as *coirce* **keʃg'**, and *suairc* **suəʃg'**. SOG did not pronounce **r'** in this fashion, neither do the people of Faulmore. Sb's **r'** was very probably a one tap-consonant. In Doohoma AOS used a very fricative **r'** ; his pronunciation of **hr'** was **ʃ**, e.g. **ʃev'** *threibh.*

Chapter V

GLIDES

195. A glide is an unavoidable short transitory sound produced by the movement of passing from the position of one speech sound to that of the next. In Irish glides are particularly perceptible in the movement of passing from velar and velarized consonants to front vowels, and vice versa in passing from palatal and palatalized consonants to back vowels. In passing to or from the open vowels—the *a*-sounds—the glides are not so noticeable for the simple reason that the /**a**/phoneme is most elastic and easily accommodates itself to an adjoining consonant by using that one of its allophones which is most adjustable to the situation.

196. There are off-glides from consonants to vowels : they are $^{u\ o\ ə\ i\ e}$; and there are on-glides from vowels to consonants : these are $^{ə\ i}$

197. The off-glides $^{u\ i}$ have tongue and lip positions and quality approximately of short **u** (§ 66) and short **i** (§ 35) respectively. The tongue position for ^{o} is about or below the half-close line and somewhat advanced with very slight lip rounding. ^{e} has approximately the quality of short **e** (§ 44) slightly retracted. ^{ə} is central and has the tongue raising of the more open **ə**, while lips are neutral.

198. Off-glides occur in the following situations :

(i) Velarized bilabials have ^{u} before a close or half-close front vowel, e.g. **b^{u}i:** *buidhe,* **f^{u}i:** *faoi,* **m^{u}i:l'** *maoil,* **b^{u}il'ə** *buille,* **f^{u}il'** *fuil,* **p^{u}e:^{ə}l** *pael,* **m^{u}el'** *moill.*

(ii) The true velars **k**, **g**, **x**, **ɣ**, **ŋ**, have a glide of quality between an unrounded **u** and **o** (here written ^{o}) when followed by a close vowel, e.g. **ə ɣ^{o}i:** *an ghaoth,* **bro:g^{o}i:** *bróga,* **k^{o}id'** *cuid.* They have a glide of more open **o**-quality when a half-close vowel follows, e.g. **g^{o}e:lg'ə** *Gaoidhealg,* **k^{o}el'** *coill,* **k^{o}erk'ə** *coirce.*

(iii) Dentals have a glide of **ə**-quality when they are followed by a front vowel, e.g. **d^{ə}i:n'ə** *daoine,* **n^{ə}i:sg** *naosg.*

(iv) Palatalized bilabials have ⁱ before a close back vowel, e.g. **f'ⁱu:** *fiú*, and ᵉ before half-close **o:** and open **a:**, e.g. **b'ᵉo:** *beó*, **f'ᵉa:** *feadh*.

(v) Similarly palato-velars, e.g. **k'ⁱu:ⁱn'** *ciúin*, **k'ᵉo:** *ceó* ; and palatals, e.g. **ʟ'ⁱu:a:n** *liomhán*, **ʟ'ᵉo:** *leó*, **ʟ'ᵉa:w** *leaghadh*.

199. On-glides occur in the following situations :

(i) ᵊ occurs before velar and velarized consonants following a close or half-close long front vowel, e.g. **b'i:ᵊf** *bíodh*, **k'i:ᵊb** *cíob*, **ɣi:ᵊm** *dhíom*, **dri:ᵊxdə** *draoidheacht*, **f'il'i:ᵊxd** *filidheacht*, **ʃi:ᵊg** *síog*, **i:ᵊk** *íoc*, **ʃi:ᵊl** *síol*, **f'i:ᵊn** *fíon*, **ʃi:ᵊdə** *síoda*, **kᵒi:ᵊrə** *caora*, **gᵒe:ᵊl** *Gaoidheal* ; and following the diphthong **əi**, e.g. **trəiᵊn** *traghan*, **səiᵊd** *soighead*.

(ii) ⁱ occurs as an on-glide before palatal and palatalized consonants, when a back vowel, and more especially a long back vowel, or the diphthong **əu**, precedes, e.g. **su:ⁱl'** *súil*, **o:ⁱg'** *óig*, **ko:ⁱr'** *cóir*, **ʟa:ⁱb'** *láib*, **m'əuⁱr'** *meabhair*.

(iii) Following back vowels, and the diphthong **əu**, ᵊ occurs as an on-glide to **r**, and is particularly perceptible when **r** is in word final position, e.g. **ku:ᵊr** *cubhar*, **ʟ'əuᵊr** *leabhar*.

200. The on-glide to a final consonant closing a stressed syllable is more clearly perceptible than the on-glide to the same consonant in a non-final position : thus the on-glide is more prominent in **f'i:ᵊr** *fíor*, for example, than in **f'i:riʃg'ə** *fíor-uisge*, and more prominent in **ʟəiᵊr** *ladhar* than in **ʟəira:n** *ladhrán*.

201. No appreciable glides are perceptible flanking **s** or **ʃ** either as off- or on-glides, e.g. **ʃi:s** *síos*, **ʃo:l** *seól*, **si:ə** *suidhe*.

202. The consonantal glides ʷ and ʲ are of frequent occurrence as hiatus fillers.

Examples—(i) **du:ʷa:n** *dubhán*, **krũ:ʷo:g** *crumhóg*, **kũ:ʷi:** *cumhaidh*, **wəuʷər** *uabhar*, **təuʷə** *togha* ; (ii) **m'i:ʲa:** *mí-ágh*, **si:ʲə** *suidhe*, **kləiʲə** *cloidhe*.

As well as internally in words, these glides occur also at word juncture.[1]

203. A transitional post-alveolar **ḍ** indifferently may or may not occur within the groups **lr** and **nr** in medial position in a word, and at word juncture. In the group **lr** in such cases the

[1] The off-glide ʷ bilabializes a following **h** in the place-name *Ceathramha Thaidhg* **k'ahru: 'fəig'<k'ahru:ʷhəig'.**

l may cease before the **r** begins. That is to say in breaking off sharply the partial closure for **l**, that is the contact between the tip of the tongue and the teeth-ridge, what amounts to complete closure followed by release occurs, in other words post-alveolar **ḍ**, e.g. **ʃi:lru:/ʃi:lᵈru:** *síolrughadh*, **ə fa:l ra:n'/fa:lᵈra:n'** *ag fagháil aráin*.

204. Similarly, in the case of the group **nr**, **n** may cease before **r** begins. The velum may be raised to touch the back wall of the pharynx before the lingual contact with the teeth-ridge is broken off. The result is a post-alveolar plosive (**ḍ**).

Examples—**ko:nrə/ko:nᵈrə** *comhra*, **unru:/unᵈru:** *ionnradh*, **hanri:/hanᵈri:** *Hanraoi*, **br'iən ruə/br'iənᵈruə** *Brian Ruadh*, **bal'ən ro:bə/bal'ənᵈro:bə** *Baile an Rodhba*, **gən rah/gənᵈrah** *gan rath*.

205. Where a voiceless **r** (**hr**) follows **l** or **n**, the transitional post-alveolar consonant that develops is unvoiced : it is **ṭ**, not **ḍ**.

Examples—(following **l**) **malhrid'/malᵗrid'** *malairt* ; (following **n**) **anhri:/anᵗri:** *eanbhruithe*, **manhrəx/manᵗrəx** *bannrach*, **sganhri:/sganᵗri:** *sgannraigh*, **kunhrid'/kunᵗrid'** *conairt*.

Chapter VI

NASALIZATION

206. Theoretically all vowels and all consonants except plosives can be nasalized. This means they may be formed with simultaneous opening of the passage to the nose. The passage to the nose is opened by lowering the velum so that it no longer touches the back wall of the pharynx.

207. In the Irish of Erris all vowels are more or less nasalized when they occur beside a nasal consonant. Adjoining a nasal consonant **a** is clearly nasalized, e.g. **am** *am*, **mak** *mac*, **b'an** *bean*, **amʃir'** *aimsir*. In like position **u** and **i** are also nasalized, though not so strongly as **a**. Instances of nasalized **e** or **o** are extremely rare. All the long vowels occur clearly nasalized adjacent to a nasal consonant. The nasalization is strongest in the case of **a:**. In no case, however, is the nasalization so strong as in the nasal vowels of French. In an unstressed syllable the nasalization of a vowel adjacent to a nasal consonant is much less perceptible than in a stressed syllable, yet more or less nasalization is present, e.g. **ʃaxin'** *seachain*. Nasalization of a vowel occurring beside a nasal consonant is without functional significance, is non-phonemic, and consequently is left unmarked generally throughout this book.

208. **w** and **v'** adjoining a nasalized vowel in a stressed syllable are clearly nasalized. When **w** follows **ã**, it is particularly strongly nasalized, e.g. **g'ãwər** *geamhar*, **sãwru:** *samhradh*. A strongly nasalized **w** follows **ã:** also, e.g. **lã:w** *lámh*, **mad'ə rã:wə** *maide rámha*.

209. A nasalized **r** is found following **k**, **g**, **m**, **t**, and preceding a nasalized vowel in a number of words, e.g. **krũk** *cnoc*, **gr'ĩ:w** *gníomh*, **mrã:** *mná*, **sə trã:w** *sa tsnámh*. **r** is more clearly nasalized when it precedes **ã:** than when it precedes any other nasalized vowel. Nasalization of **r** is particularly strong in **mrã:** *mná* and **mrĩ:** *mnaoi*, where **m** precedes. (Cf. §§ 75–87).

Chapter VII

SANDHI

210. Juxtapositional assimilation takes place at word juncture in an utterance. When such assimilation occurs between two words it is regularly the initial sound of the second word which effects a change in the final sound of the first word. The organs of speech in anticipation of the second sound take a short cut in their movement towards the position appropriate to its articulation. One sound is replaced by another owing to the influence of a third neighbouring sound.

211. The commonest change in Irish is from velar to palatal quality in a consonant under the influence of a following palatal, and vice versa from palatal to velar quality under the influence of a following velar.

212. **ɴ**, **ʟ**, **n**, **l** are replaced by **ɴ'**, **ʟ'** under the influence of **ɴ'**, **ʟ'**, e.g. **e:ɴ' ʟ'əur** *aon leabhar*, **k'aɴ' ʟ'ahən** *ceann leathan*, **bud'e:ʟ' ɴ'artu:l'** *buidéal neartamhail*.

213. Preceding the affricates **d'**, **t'**, occurring initially in a stressed syllable, **ɴ**, **n**, > **ɴ'**, e.g. **kraɴ' d'el'iv'ə** *crann deilbhe*, **ʃaɴ' t'i:ra:nəx** *sean-tioránach*. **ʟ** > **ʟ'** under the influence of a following **d'**, which itself becomes assimilated and merged in the **ʟ'** in the isolated case of **poʟ' ati:** *poll deataigh*.

214. **ɴ**, **ʟ**, **ɴ'**, **ʟ'**, **n**, **l**, > **n'**, **l'** under the influence of a following **ʃ**, **l'**, e.g. **k'an' ʃaxdin'ə** *ceann seachtmhaine*, **hin' ʃi:** *sheinn sí*, **harin' ʃe:** *tharrainn sé*, **do:l' ʃe:** *d'ól sé*, **hr'iəl' ʃe:** *thriall sé*, **tarin' l'at** *tarrainn leat*, **ɴ'i:l' ẽ: çiəl' l'eʃ** *ní fhuil aon chiall leis*.

215. Alveolar **n**, **l** > dental **ɴ**, **ʟ** under the influence of a following **d**, **t**, **ɴ**, e.g. **si:ʟ dunə** *saoghal dona*, **ku:la:ɴ tali:** *cúlán talaimh*, **bri:ɴ do:** *braon dó*.

216. All other *n*- and *l*-sounds are replaced by alveolar **n** and **l** under the influence of a following **s**, **r**, e.g. **a: m'ensə** *dá mbeinn-se*, **ə gol suəs** *ag gabháil suas*, **boxəl rãwər** *buachaill reamhar*.

217. **ɴ'**, **ʟ'**, **n'**, **l'** are replaced by **ɴ**, **ʟ** under the influence of a following **ɴ**, **ʟ**, **d**, or **t**, e.g. **p'i:ɴ dit'** *peinginn duit*, **inʃəɴ do:** *innsin dó*, **riɴ/ruɴ tu:** *rinne tú*, **ə gluɴ tu:** *an gcluin tú?* **si:v'əɴ dit'**